From Beginner to Intermediate

Relaxed movement, secure reading and a shared pulse.

How to use these notes

Read alongside the lessons or keep beside your piano. Review the explanations, try the practice tasks, then use the checklist without on-screen hints. Listening and demonstrations are available in the app. Notation examples show the opening two bars; full songs are in the Songbook.

In this chapter

1. A calm starting point
2. Moving without stretching
3. Different lengths in each hand
4. Reading one group ahead
5. Keep the musical sentence moving
6. Jesus Loves Me: coordinated hands
7. The Doxology: a shared pulse
8. Amazing Grace

1. A calm starting point

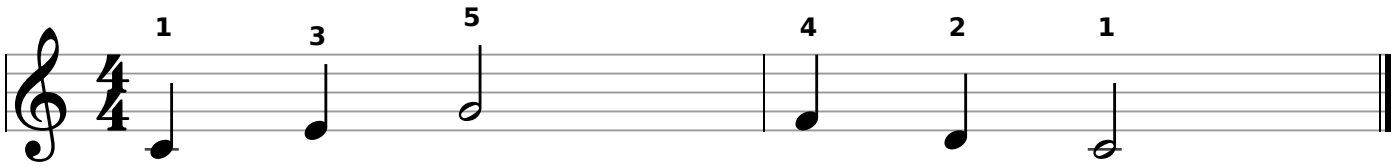
Check reading, counting and relaxed coordination.

A calm starting point

Before adding difficulty, play a short passage with each hand. Find the key and time signature, say the starting notes, and count one empty bar. Your wrist should move with the hand rather than hold it rigidly in place. If the bass reading or counting feels unfamiliar, revisit the matching Beginner chapter; the intermediate section stays available.

Practise · Right-hand check

Read before playing. Keep each quarter even.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Left-hand check

Use the bass staff. Say the beat while the note is held.

Listen and check

Could you locate the notes without a lit key? Repeat the harder hand at half speed. Continue when the passage feels comfortable, not merely when the app turns green.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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2. Moving without stretching

Use the arm to carry the hand to its next position.

Moving without stretching

A position is a temporary starting place, not a shape you must keep stretched. Play a five-note group, release unnecessary pressure, and let the forearm carry the hand sideways to the next group. Keep the thumb near the keys and use its side. Stop if a movement hurts; smaller relaxed movements are the aim.

Practise · Two neighbourhoods

Play C to G, release, then move the whole hand to G position.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Left-hand travel

Look at the destination before moving. Keep the shoulders quiet.

Listen and check

Did the arm travel with the hand, or did the fingers reach while the wrist stayed behind? Practise the move silently twice, then repeat with sound.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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3. Different lengths in each hand

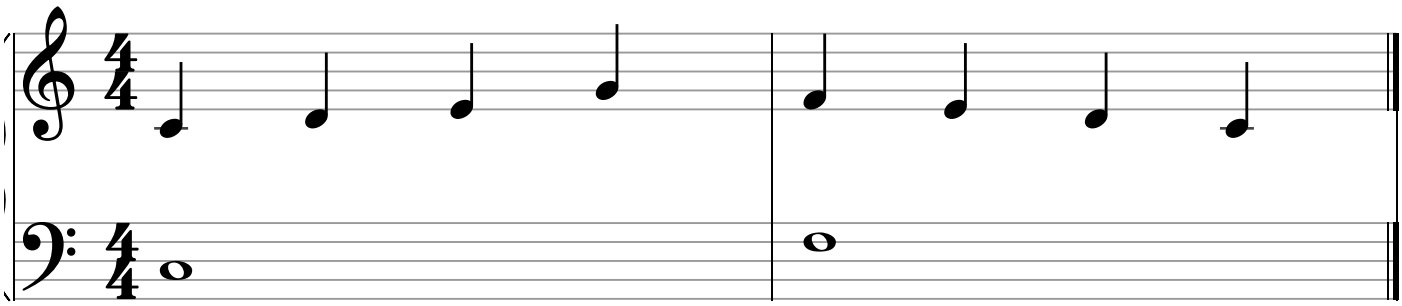
Let the melody move while the bass stays held.

Different lengths in each hand

Both hands share one pulse, but they do not always change together. Count four beats while holding a bass note; the right hand can play four separate notes above it. Release only the fingers whose notes have ended. First tap the two rhythms on your knees so finding pitches does not distract you.

Practise · One bass, four melody notes

Hold the left C through four right-hand notes.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Change on beat three

The left hand changes halfway through the bar. Count aloud.

Listen and check

Listen for an accidental gap in the long bass notes. The app can hear the starts, but you must check that the held hand stays down.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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4. Reading one group ahead

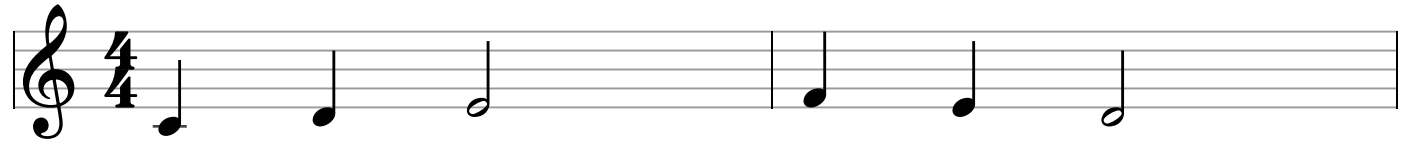
Prepare the next pattern while playing the current one.

Reading one group ahead

Read in small groups. Before starting, find the first note of each bar and notice repeated shapes. While holding a half note, glance at the next group. Do not try to read a whole page ahead. Use an easy tempo so your eyes can move without your hands racing.

Practise · Look during the half note

Use each half note as a chance to preview the next group.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Bass preview

Name the next bass note before the current note ends.

Listen and check

Describe the next bar before you play it. If you rely on the highlighted key, use Show me once, then repeat without it.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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5. Keep the musical sentence moving
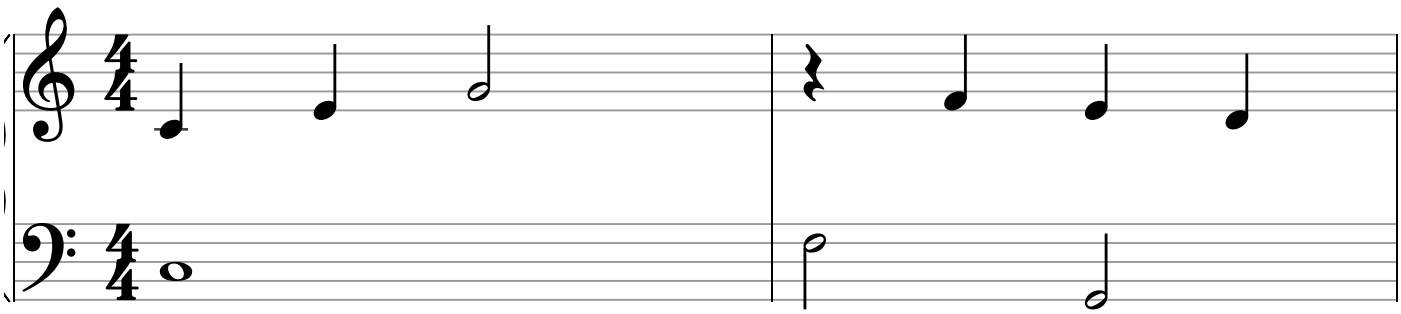
Recover without restarting the whole piece.

Keep the musical sentence moving

In careful practice, stop to repair a mistake. In a performance run, keep the pulse and join at the next secure note. These are different useful habits. Choose a slow tempo, mark two restart points, and count through a planned silent bar. Missing a note need not erase the beat.

Practise · Count through silence

Keep counting through the rest; do not shorten the empty beat.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · A fresh starting point

Start confidently from this second phrase instead of returning to the beginning.

Listen and check

Try Flow at a comfortable speed for one continuous run. Then return to ordinary practice and loop the bar that caused hesitation.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

6. Jesus Loves Me: coordinated hands

Let the melody move above a quiet held bass. Release each bass only at its written change.

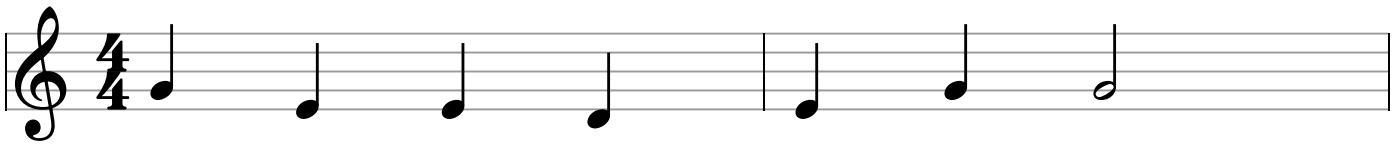
What to listen for

Let the melody move above a quiet held bass. Release each bass only at its written change.

Prepare the opening with separate hands. Then use Play along, choose the hand you want to practise, and loop the troublesome bars. Count the pickup as bar 1 in the loop selector.

Practise · Melody alone

Let the melody move above a quiet held bass. Release each bass only at its written change.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Accompaniment alone

Play the left hand softly. Count through the held notes and rests.

Practise · Opening together

Let the melody move above a quiet held bass. Release each bass only at its written change.

Practise · Jesus Loves Me: coordinated hands

Let the melody move above a quiet held bass. Release each bass only at its written change.

Your musical check

Can you sing the tune and hear a continuous bass beneath it?

Play again without the demonstration. Explain what you changed and whether it sounded better.

7. The Doxology: a shared pulse

Use the complete familiar tune to coordinate changes without rushing the melody.

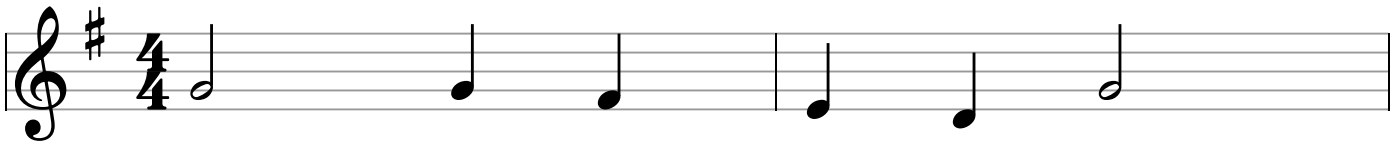
What to listen for

Use the complete familiar tune to coordinate changes without rushing the melody.

Prepare the opening with separate hands. Then use Play along, choose the hand you want to practise, and loop the troublesome bars. Count the pickup as bar 1 in the loop selector.

Practise · Melody alone

Use the complete familiar tune to coordinate changes without rushing the melody.



Opening example · 4/4 · G · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Accompaniment alone

Play the left hand softly. Count through the held notes and rests.

Practise · Opening together

Use the complete familiar tune to coordinate changes without rushing the melody.

Practise · The Doxology: a shared pulse

Use the complete familiar tune to coordinate changes without rushing the melody.

Your musical check

Count through the final Amen and release both hands together.

Play again without the demonstration. Explain what you changed and whether it sounded better.

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8. Amazing Grace

Keep the waltz pulse, hold the bass notes fully and shape each phrase.
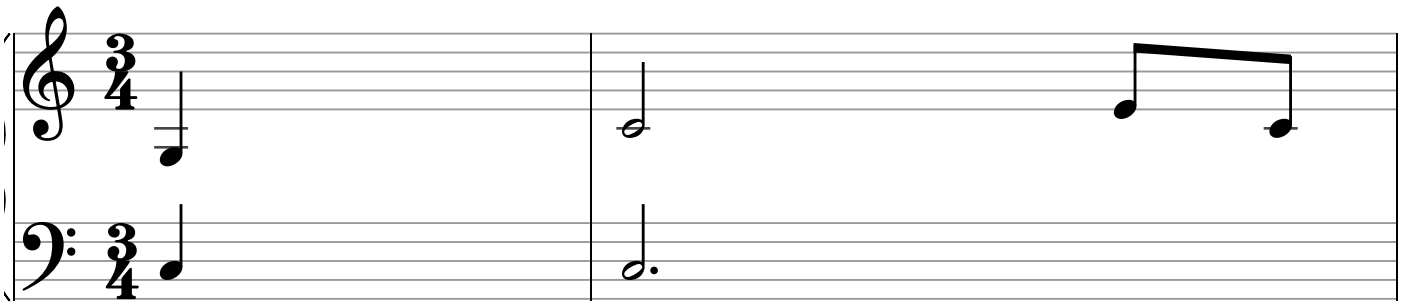
Prepare your recital

Keep the waltz pulse, hold the bass notes fully and shape each phrase.

Choose a comfortable tempo. Practise difficult bars separately, then reconnect them. Make one uninterrupted run before marking your recital complete. Completion records a play-through, not a certified grade.

Practise · Dress rehearsal: Amazing Grace

Keep the waltz pulse, hold the bass notes fully and shape each phrase.



Opening example · 3/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Your recital

Take a breath, prepare the starting notes, and play through. Keep going after a small mistake. Keep the waltz pulse, hold the bass notes fully and shape each phrase.

Can I do this independently?

Try these at your piano with hints and note labels turned off. Tick a box when you can do it comfortably; return to the matching lesson when you need a reminder.

- ☐ Check reading, counting and relaxed coordination.
- ☐ Use the arm to carry the hand to its next position.
- ☐ Let the melody move while the bass stays held.
- ☐ Prepare the next pattern while playing the current one.
- ☐ Recover without restarting the whole piece.
- ☐ Keep the waltz pulse, hold the bass notes fully and shape each phrase.

My next practice goal

What sounded better? What still needs work?

Moving Freely Around the Keyboard

Scales, arpeggios and planned movement in familiar major and minor keys.

How to use these notes

Read alongside the lessons or keep beside your piano. Review the explanations, try the practice tasks, then use the checklist without on-screen hints. Listening and demonstrations are available in the app. Notation examples show the opening two bars; full songs are in the Songbook.

In this chapter

1. Two-octave major scales
2. Natural and harmonic minor
3. Plan the fingering before the leap
4. Arpeggios without a stretched hand
5. Read the pattern, not every isolated note
6. Holy, Holy, Holy: D-major movement
7. What a Friend: F-major patterns
8. Joyful, Joyful in G

1. Two-octave major scales

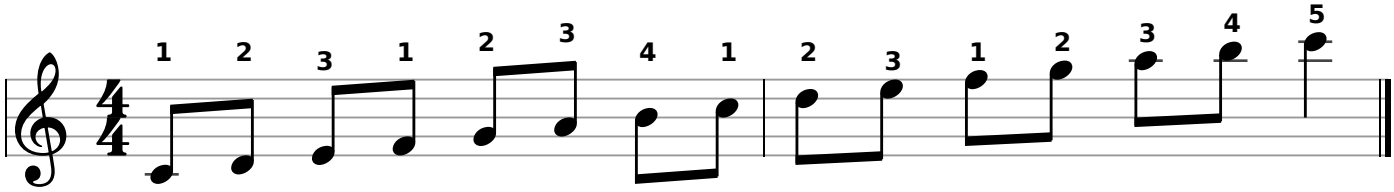
Join the middle octave with an organised fingering.

Two-octave major scales

Practise C, G and F major first, then D and B-flat. In a two-octave right-hand C scale, use 1 2 3, 1 2 3 4, then cross to 1 for the next octave; save 5 for the very top. The middle C is not an ending. Move the forearm along the keyboard and keep the thumb crossing small.

Practise · C major, two octaves

Hands separately first. Use 1 at the middle C and 5 only at the top.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · B-flat preparation

Right hand: begin with 2 on B-flat. Avoid twisting to tuck the thumb.

Practise · G major, two octaves

Hands separately. Keep the middle octave moving and reverse calmly at the top.

Practise · F major, two octaves

Hands separately. Keep the middle octave moving and reverse calmly at the top.

Practise · D major, two octaves

Hands separately. Keep the middle octave moving and reverse calmly at the top.

Practise · Bb major, two octaves

Hands separately. Keep the middle octave moving and reverse calmly at the top.

Practise · C major, left hand

Use 1 at the middle C, cross 4 to D above it, and reverse the same route.

Listen and check

Play the ascent and descent offline with the same relaxed crossings. Practise G with C fingering, F with 4 on B-flat, and D with 3 on F-sharp; do not raise speed until the joins are even.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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2. Natural and harmonic minor

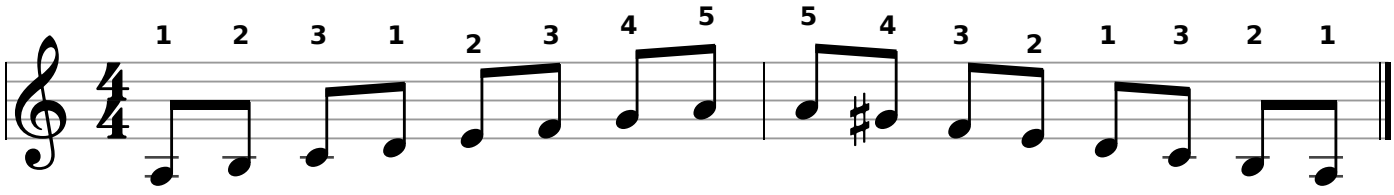
Hear the raised seventh lead toward the home note.

Natural and harmonic minor

A natural minor shares the white keys with C major. Harmonic minor raises the seventh: G becomes G-sharp in A minor. Compare the two sounds before memorising a pattern. Prepare A, D and E minor separately; D harmonic minor raises C to C-sharp and E harmonic minor raises D to D-sharp.

Practise · A minor: two colours

Play natural minor, then notice the raised G-sharp.



Opening example · 4/4 · Am · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · D and E leading notes

Hear each raised seventh resolve upward. Use small hand movements.

Practise · Am harmonic minor

Use the raised seventh in both directions. Keep the wider step relaxed.

Practise · Dm harmonic minor

Use the raised seventh in both directions. Keep the wider step relaxed.

Practise · Em harmonic minor

Use the raised seventh in both directions. Keep the wider step relaxed.

Listen and check

Sing the final two notes before playing them. Can you explain which note changed and why its pull toward home sounds stronger?

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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3. Plan the fingering before the leap

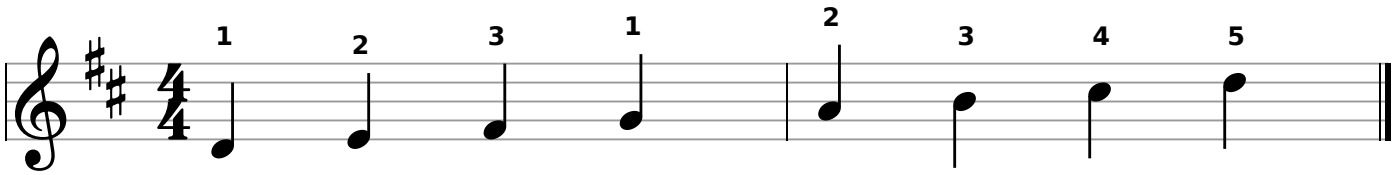
Use consistent fingers and release between positions.

Plan the fingering before the leap

A useful fingering supports the musical shape and fits your hand. Mark the beginning of each group, the highest note, and each crossing. Try a choice slowly twice before keeping it. Changing fingers every attempt makes the movement harder to remember. Releasing between groups is safer than forcing a large stretch.

Practise · An organised crossing

Use the written crossing and let the arm follow the hand.



Opening example · 4/4 · D · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Prepare a new position

Release during the rest and look at the landing note.

Listen and check

Could you repeat the same fingering three times without a last-second scramble? If not, slow down and plan the move before adding the preceding bar.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

4. Arpeggios without a stretched hand

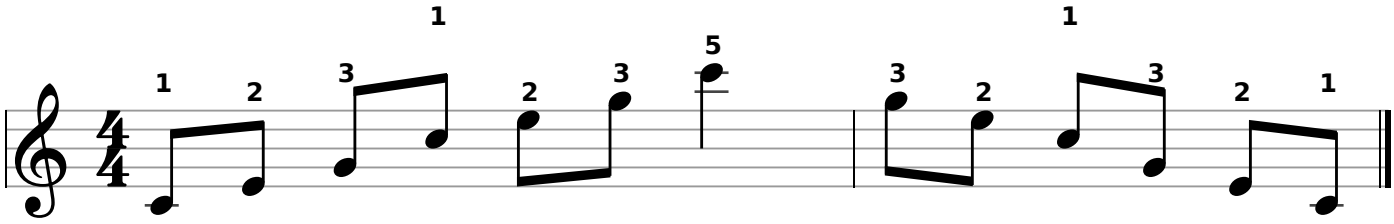
Travel through chord tones one note at a time.

Arpeggios without a stretched hand

An arpeggio spreads a chord across time. First identify the notes, then choose a fingering that lets the arm travel. In the right-hand C pattern below, 1 2 3 leads to 1 on the next C. Practise one octave before joining two. Keep the wrist flexible; the fingers do not need to stay spread after their notes end.

Practise · Right-hand C arpeggio

Travel C-E-G-C. Cross gently, then reverse the movement.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Left-hand chord tones

Start with a comfortable octave. Move rather than stretch.

Listen and check

Listen for bumps at the thumb crossings. Repeat the crossing pair alone, then place it back into the full arpeggio.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

5. Read the pattern, not every isolated note
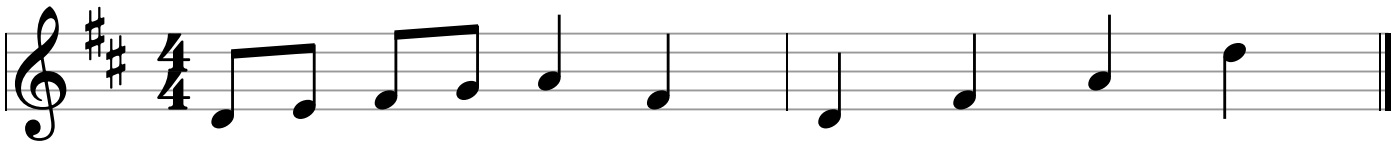
Recognise scales, chords and repeated sequences.

Read the pattern, not every isolated note

Before playing a passage, circle the notes that belong to a scale and bracket the notes that outline a chord. An accidental is a useful warning that the pattern changes. Pattern recognition reduces the amount you have to decode, but always check the starting pitch and the direction.

Practise · Scale then chord

Name the first group as a scale and the second as a broken chord.



Opening example · 4/4 · D · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · The same shape, another key

Notice the same contour beginning on F.

Listen and check

Look away from the keyboard and describe the shape: up by step, skip, or chord. Can you identify the same pattern in the hymn study?

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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6. Holy, Holy, Holy: D-major movement

Find the D-major shapes before playing. Keep the running left hand soft and the repeated melody notes calm.
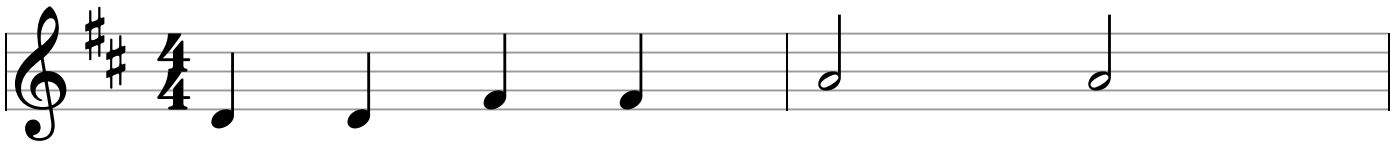
What to listen for

Find the D-major shapes before playing. Keep the running left hand soft and the repeated melody notes calm.

Prepare the opening with separate hands. Then use Play along, choose the hand you want to practise, and loop the troublesome bars. Count the pickup as bar 1 in the loop selector.

Practise · Melody alone

Find the D-major shapes before playing. Keep the running left hand soft and the repeated melody notes calm.



Opening example · 4/4 · D · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Accompaniment alone

Play the left hand softly. Count through the held notes and rests.

Practise · Opening together

Find the D-major shapes before playing. Keep the running left hand soft and the repeated melody notes calm.

Practise · Holy, Holy, Holy: D-major movement

Find the D-major shapes before playing. Keep the running left hand soft and the repeated melody notes calm.

Your musical check

Loop one position change, then join it to the preceding bar.

Play again without the demonstration. Explain what you changed and whether it sounded better.

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7. What a Friend: F-major patterns

Prepare B-flat and identify scale fragments before adding the broken-chord accompaniment.
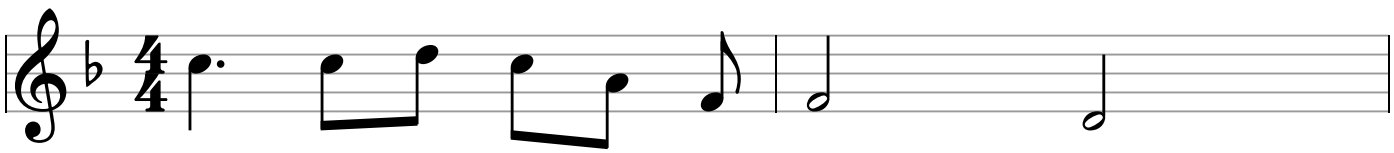
What to listen for

Prepare B-flat and identify scale fragments before adding the broken-chord accompaniment.

Prepare the opening with separate hands. Then use Play along, choose the hand you want to practise, and loop the troublesome bars. Count the pickup as bar 1 in the loop selector.

Practise · Melody alone

Prepare B-flat and identify scale fragments before adding the broken-chord accompaniment.



Opening example · 4/4 · F · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Accompaniment alone

Play the left hand softly. Count through the held notes and rests.

Practise · Opening together

Prepare B-flat and identify scale fragments before adding the broken-chord accompaniment.

Practise · What a Friend: F-major patterns

Prepare B-flat and identify scale fragments before adding the broken-chord accompaniment.

Your musical check

Did your arm travel with the hand without stretching for the next group?

Play again without the demonstration. Explain what you changed and whether it sounded better.

8. Joyful, Joyful in G

Keep scale-like melody patterns even above a soft arpeggiated accompaniment.

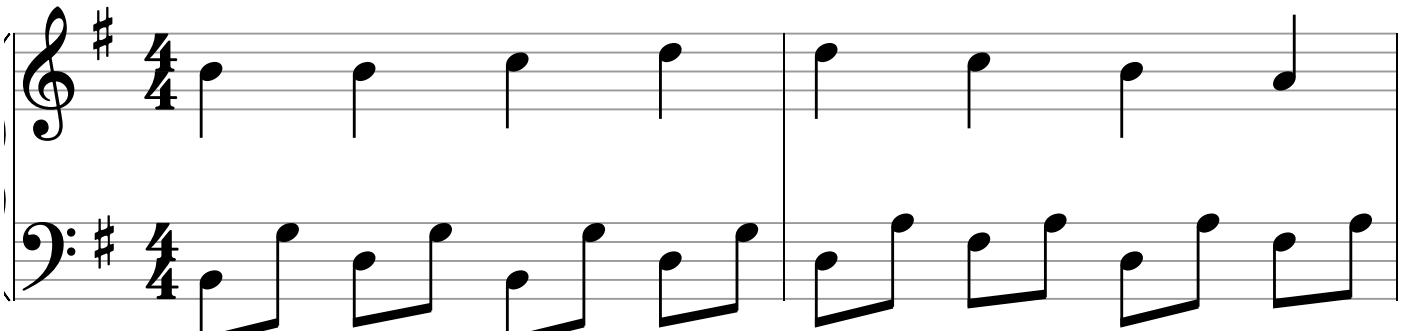
Prepare your recital

Keep scale-like melody patterns even above a soft arpeggiated accompaniment.

Choose a comfortable tempo. Practise difficult bars separately, then reconnect them. Make one uninterrupted run before marking your recital complete. Completion records a play-through, not a certified grade.

Practise · Dress rehearsal: Joyful, Joyful in G

Keep scale-like melody patterns even above a soft arpeggiated accompaniment.



Opening example · 4/4 · G · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Your recital

Take a breath, prepare the starting notes, and play through. Keep going after a small mistake. Keep scale-like melody patterns even above a soft arpeggiated accompaniment.

Can I do this independently?

Try these at your piano with hints and note labels turned off. Tick a box when you can do it comfortably; return to the matching lesson when you need a reminder.

- ☐ Join the middle octave with an organised fingering.
- ☐ Hear the raised seventh lead toward the home note.
- ☐ Use consistent fingers and release between positions.
- ☐ Travel through chord tones one note at a time.
- ☐ Recognise scales, chords and repeated sequences.
- ☐ Keep scale-like melody patterns even above a soft arpeggiated accompaniment.

My next practice goal

What sounded better? What still needs work?

Understanding Hymn Harmony

Triads, inversions, dominant sevenths and convincing cadences.

How to use these notes

Read alongside the lessons or keep beside your piano. Review the explanations, try the practice tasks, then use the checklist without on-screen hints. Listening and demonstrations are available in the app. Notation examples show the opening two bars; full songs are in the Songbook.

In this chapter

1. Build chords from the key
2. Choose the nearest inversion
3. I, IV, V and vi
4. The dominant seventh
5. Recognise musical punctuation
6. Rock of Ages: connected chord shapes
7. When I Survey: harmonic punctuation
8. Take My Life and Let It Be

1. Build chords from the key

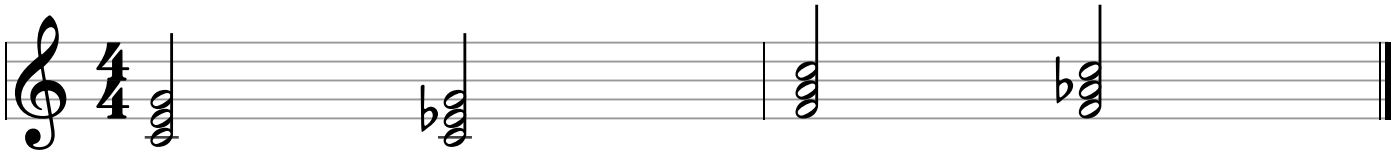
Find major and minor triads without memorising hand shapes.

Build chords from the key

Build a triad from a root, third and fifth. C-E-G is major; C-E-flat-G is minor because the third is lower. A similar finger shape can make a different quality on another root, so name the notes and listen. Practise C, F, G, D and B-flat major, then A, D and E minor.

Practise · Major becomes minor

Only the middle note changes. Listen to the colour.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Left-hand triads

Use a comfortable 5-3-1 shape; release between chords.

Listen and check

Name the root, third and fifth before each chord. Can you change major to minor without moving the root or fifth?

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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2. Choose the nearest inversion

Keep common tones and reduce unnecessary jumps.

Choose the nearest inversion

A chord keeps its identity when a different chord tone sits at the bottom. Choose inversions that leave shared notes near one another. C-E-G can move to C-F-A by moving two fingers a small distance. Look at each voice as a little melody. Do not squeeze the hand into a shape that hurts.

Practise · C-F-G-C in a small space

Keep the common C for F. Move the other notes smoothly.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Left-hand inversions

Prepare the whole next chord silently before sounding it.

Listen and check

Play just the top notes of the chords and listen to their line. Then restore the other notes without making the top line disappear.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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3. I, IV, V and vi

Understand the jobs of the most useful hymn chords.

I, IV, V and vi

Roman numerals name chords by their position in a key. In C, I is C major, IV is F, V is G and vi is A minor. Uppercase means major here; lowercase means minor. Learn the sound of leaving home and returning, not just the symbols. The same functions work in G: G, C, D and E minor.

Practise · C-major journey

Say I, vi, IV, V while playing the left-hand chords.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · G-major journey

Keep the notes close: G, E minor, C, D.

Listen and check

Hum the bass line and identify the moment that sounds like a return home. Try the progression from memory before looking at the notation again.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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4. The dominant seventh

Hear tension resolve without playing a large chord.

The dominant seventh

Add F to G-B-D and you have G7. In C major, B often rises to C while F falls to E. You can hear this pull using only two notes. A pianist may omit a doubled note or the fifth to make the chord comfortable. Learn the resolution before adding a full four-note shape.

Practise · Two notes show the resolution

Hear B move up and F move down.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · A compact G7

Left hand: the fifth D is omitted. Keep the movement small.

Listen and check

Play the seventh chord, pause, and sing the home note you expect next. Then play the resolution and compare.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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5. Recognise musical punctuation

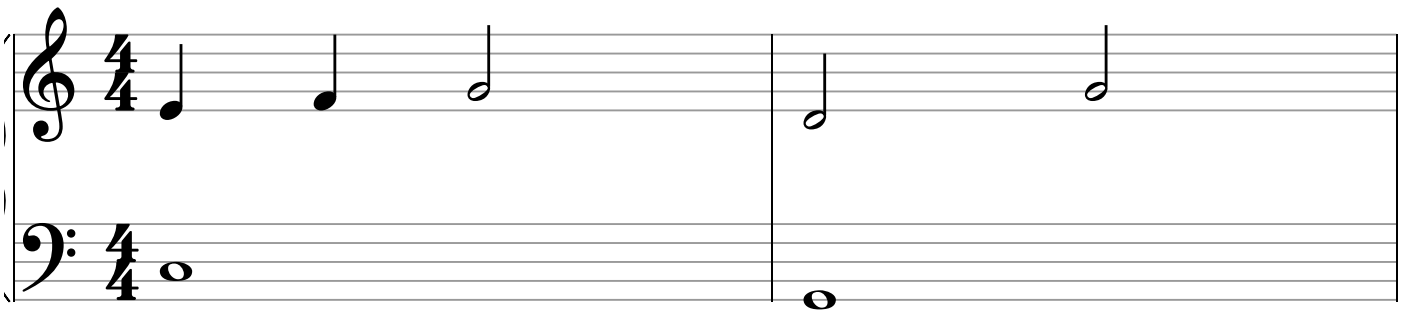
Choose a convincing pause or ending.

Recognise musical punctuation

A cadence is a harmonic punctuation mark. V-I sounds like an arrival, while a phrase ending on V often sounds unfinished. IV-I gives another familiar hymn ending. Keep the pulse through the cadence; slowing every time can break the musical sentence. Save a deliberate final broadening for a chosen ending.

Practise · Question and answer

The first phrase stops on G; the second comes home to C.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Amen cadence

Listen for IV-I: F major to C major.

Listen and check

Which phrase could finish the hymn and which invites another phrase? Try identifying a cadence in Rock of Ages before reading the accompaniment.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

6. Rock of Ages: connected chord shapes

Read each left-hand chord as a whole shape. Keep common tones and count the three-beat bars.
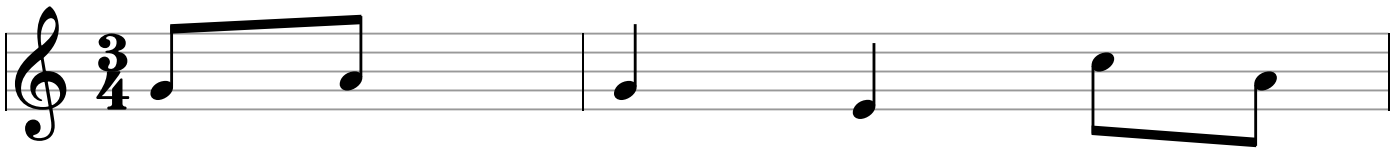
What to listen for

Read each left-hand chord as a whole shape. Keep common tones and count the three-beat bars.

Prepare the opening with separate hands. Then use Play along, choose the hand you want to practise, and loop the troublesome bars. Count the pickup as bar 1 in the loop selector.

Practise · Melody alone

Read each left-hand chord as a whole shape. Keep common tones and count the three-beat bars.



Opening example · 3/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Accompaniment alone

Play the left hand softly. Count through the held notes and rests.

Practise · Opening together

Read each left-hand chord as a whole shape. Keep common tones and count the three-beat bars.

Practise · Rock of Ages: connected chord shapes

Read each left-hand chord as a whole shape. Keep common tones and count the three-beat bars.

Your musical check

Name the chord roots and listen for the final return to C.

Play again without the demonstration. Explain what you changed and whether it sounded better.

7. When I Survey: harmonic punctuation

Listen for the phrases that end at home and those that invite another phrase.

What to listen for

Listen for the phrases that end at home and those that invite another phrase.

Prepare the opening with separate hands. Then use Play along, choose the hand you want to practise, and loop the troublesome bars. Count the pickup as bar 1 in the loop selector.

Practise · Melody alone

Listen for the phrases that end at home and those that invite another phrase.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Accompaniment alone

Play the left hand softly. Count through the held notes and rests.

Practise · Opening together

Listen for the phrases that end at home and those that invite another phrase.

Practise · When I Survey: harmonic punctuation

Listen for the phrases that end at home and those that invite another phrase.

Your musical check

Play only the last two chords of each phrase and describe their effect.

Play again without the demonstration. Explain what you changed and whether it sounded better.

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8. Take My Life and Let It Be

Keep the melody clear above compact chord inversions. Show the cadence without an unplanned pause.

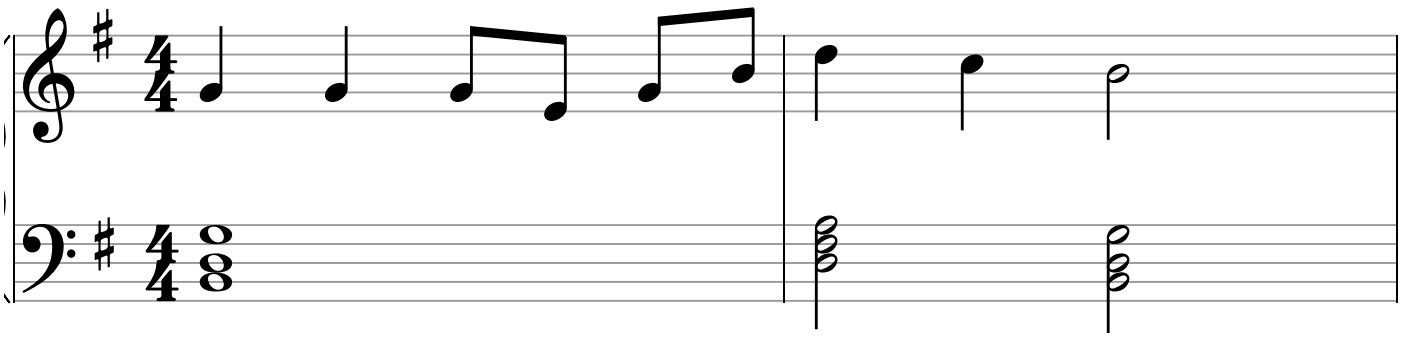
Prepare your recital

Keep the melody clear above compact chord inversions. Show the cadence without an unplanned pause.

Choose a comfortable tempo. Practise difficult bars separately, then reconnect them. Make one uninterrupted run before marking your recital complete. Completion records a play-through, not a certified grade.

Practise · Dress rehearsal: Take My Life and Let It Be

Keep the melody clear above compact chord inversions. Show the cadence without an unplanned pause.



Opening example · 4/4 · G · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Your recital

Take a breath, prepare the starting notes, and play through. Keep going after a small mistake. Keep the melody clear above compact chord inversions. Show the cadence without an unplanned pause.

Can I do this independently?

Try these at your piano with hints and note labels turned off. Tick a box when you can do it comfortably; return to the matching lesson when you need a reminder.

- ☐ Find major and minor triads without memorising hand shapes.
- ☐ Keep common tones and reduce unnecessary jumps.
- ☐ Understand the jobs of the most useful hymn chords.
- ☐ Hear tension resolve without playing a large chord.
- ☐ Choose a convincing pause or ending.
- ☐ Keep the melody clear above compact chord inversions. Show the cadence without an unplanned pause.

My next practice goal

What sounded better? What still needs work?

Rhythm That Keeps Moving

Subdivision, dotted rhythms, compound time, triplets and syncopation.

How to use these notes

Read alongside the lessons or keep beside your piano. Review the explanations, try the practice tasks, then use the checklist without on-screen hints. Listening and demonstrations are available in the app. Notation examples show the opening two bars; full songs are in the Songbook.

In this chapter

1. Keep the small beats even
2. Dotted rhythms and ties across the beat
3. Two and three large beats
4. Three notes in the space of two
5. Feel the beat when the melody shifts
6. Silent Night: two large beats
7. Holy, Holy, Holy: dotted precision
8. Blessed Assurance

1. Keep the small beats even

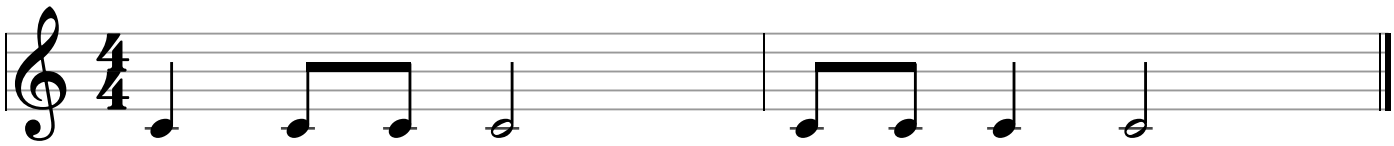
Use a reliable subdivision beneath changing rhythms.

Keep the small beats even

Count a steady stream of eighth-note subdivisions: 1-and-2-and-3-and-4-and. The spoken counting stays even when the hands hold longer notes. Start on one pitch so your attention can stay on time. In Flow, begin slowly; the app checks note starts, while you check the spaces between them.

Practise · One-key rhythm

Count the eighth-note stream through every longer note.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Rhythm against a bass

Keep the left hand steady while the melody subdivides.

Listen and check

Tap the rhythm away from the piano, then play it. If the rhythm changes when pitches are added, return to the single-note version.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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2. Dotted rhythms and ties across the beat

Keep counting when a note begins between beats.

Dotted rhythms and ties across the beat

A dotted quarter lasts three eighth-note subdivisions. Its following eighth belongs on the and of beat 2, not on beat 2 itself. A tie joins the same pitch and asks for one attack with a longer hold. Count beneath the tie so the next note arrives in the right place.

Practise · Long-short accuracy

Say 1-and-2-and; the short note lands on the final and.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · A tie crosses beat two

Do not strike the tied E twice.

Listen and check

Listen for the short note arriving too early. Clap the subdivision while someone else counts the main beats, or use a slow metronome.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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3. Two and three large beats
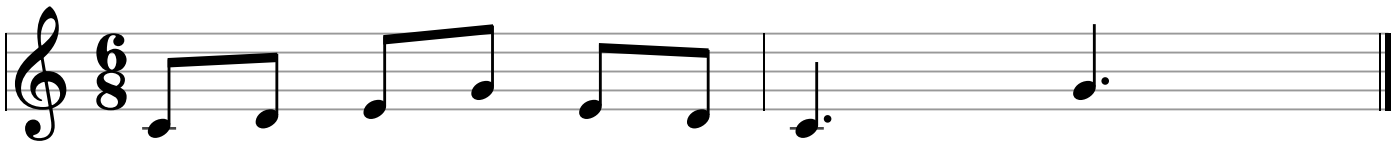
Feel 6/8 and 9/8 as groups of three eighths.

Two and three large beats

In 6/8, feel two large beats: ONE-two-three FOUR-five-six. In 9/8, feel three: ONE-two-three FOUR-five-six SEVEN-eight-nine. The dotted quarter is the large beat. Begin by counting all the eighths, then lighten the middle subdivisions. Do not make 6/8 sound like three pairs.

Practise · Two large beats

Lean gently on 1 and 4.



Opening example · 6/8 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Three large beats

Feel three groups of three, not an uneven long bar.

Listen and check

Can you sway or tap only the large beats while playing? In Blessed Assurance, prepare the pickup before the first full group.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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4. Three notes in the space of two

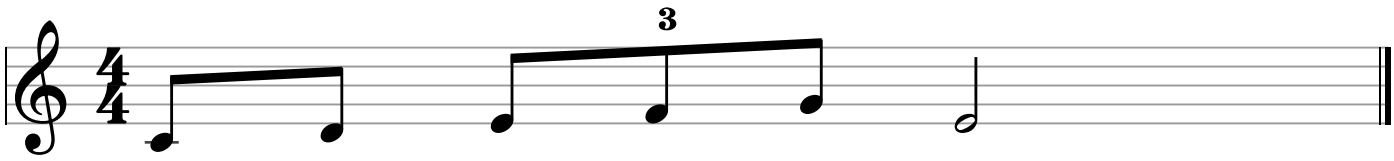
Distinguish triplets from ordinary eighth notes.

Three notes in the space of two

An eighth-note triplet divides one quarter-note beat into three equal parts. The bracket marked 3 means the three eighth-shaped notes share one beat. Say tri-po-let evenly while tapping quarters. Ordinary eighths divide that same beat into two. Keep the large beat unchanged when switching between them.

Practise · Two then three

First two eighths, then three triplet eighths on the next beat.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Triplets over quarters

Play three even right-hand notes against each left-hand quarter.

Listen and check

Listen for the middle triplet note being squeezed. Repeat on a single key, then restore the pitches while the beat stays even.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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5. Feel the beat when the melody shifts

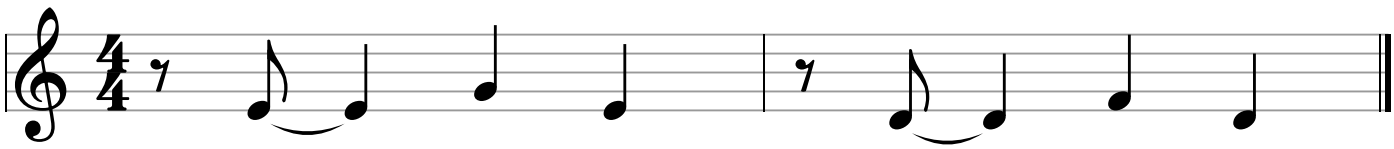
Let an offbeat note continue across a strong beat.

Feel the beat when the melody shifts

Syncopation places emphasis where you do not expect it. Here an eighth-note pickup within the bar is tied across the next beat. Keep the left hand on the beat so the right hand can lean away from it. Start by tapping; do not add accents by striking harshly.

Practise · An offbeat held across the beat

Count aloud. The tied note is one sound.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · A steady anchor

Left quarters stay steady beneath the right-hand syncopation.

Listen and check

Could a listener tap the main beat from your accompaniment? Keep this as a rhythm variation exercise; do not change a hymn rhythm unless the arrangement asks for it.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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6. Silent Night: two large beats

Count six eighths first, then feel two groups of three. Keep the accompaniment under the melody.

What to listen for

Count six eighths first, then feel two groups of three. Keep the accompaniment under the melody.

Prepare the opening with separate hands. Then use Play along, choose the hand you want to practise, and loop the troublesome bars. Count the pickup as bar 1 in the loop selector.

Practise · Melody alone

Count six eighths first, then feel two groups of three. Keep the accompaniment under the melody.



Opening example · 6/8 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Accompaniment alone

Play the left hand softly. Count through the held notes and rests.

Practise · Opening together

Count six eighths first, then feel two groups of three. Keep the accompaniment under the melody.

Practise · Silent Night: two large beats

Count six eighths first, then feel two groups of three. Keep the accompaniment under the melody.

Your musical check

Can you tap only the two large beats without losing the shorter notes?

Play again without the demonstration. Explain what you changed and whether it sounded better.

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7. Holy, Holy, Holy: dotted precision

Count the subdivisions through each dotted rhythm. Do not let the short note arrive early.
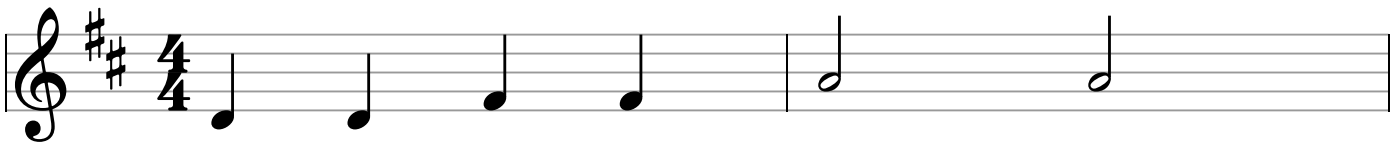
What to listen for

Count the subdivisions through each dotted rhythm. Do not let the short note arrive early.

Prepare the opening with separate hands. Then use Play along, choose the hand you want to practise, and loop the troublesome bars. Count the pickup as bar 1 in the loop selector.

Practise · Melody alone

Count the subdivisions through each dotted rhythm. Do not let the short note arrive early.



Opening example · 4/4 · D · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Accompaniment alone

Play the left hand softly. Count through the held notes and rests.

Practise · Opening together

Count the subdivisions through each dotted rhythm. Do not let the short note arrive early.

Practise · Holy, Holy, Holy: dotted precision

Count the subdivisions through each dotted rhythm. Do not let the short note arrive early.

Your musical check

Compare the first and second dotted phrases at the same tempo.

Play again without the demonstration. Explain what you changed and whether it sounded better.

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8. Blessed Assurance

Feel three large dotted-quarter beats in each 9/8 bar and place the pickup calmly.

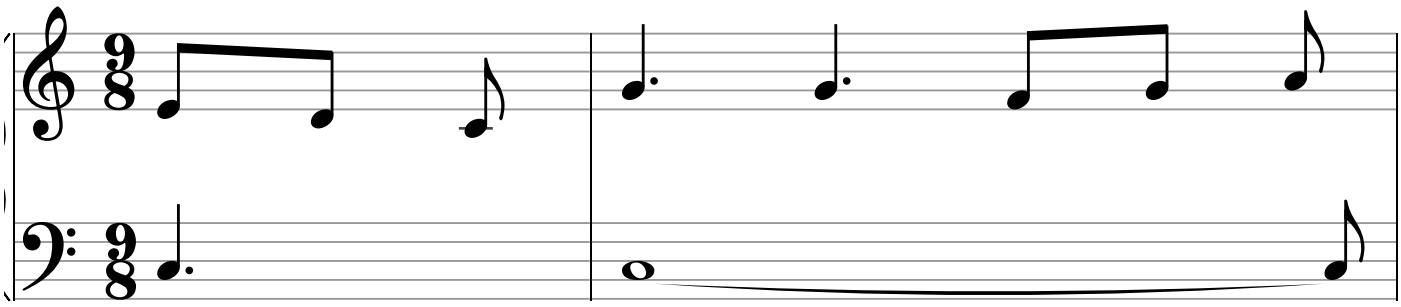
Prepare your recital

Feel three large dotted-quarter beats in each 9/8 bar and place the pickup calmly.

Choose a comfortable tempo. Practise difficult bars separately, then reconnect them. Make one uninterrupted run before marking your recital complete. Completion records a play-through, not a certified grade.

Practise · Dress rehearsal: Blessed Assurance

Feel three large dotted-quarter beats in each 9/8 bar and place the pickup calmly.



Opening example · 9/8 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Your recital

Take a breath, prepare the starting notes, and play through. Keep going after a small mistake. Feel three large dotted-quarter beats in each 9/8 bar and place the pickup calmly.

Can I do this independently?

Try these at your piano with hints and note labels turned off. Tick a box when you can do it comfortably; return to the matching lesson when you need a reminder.

- ☐ Use a reliable subdivision beneath changing rhythms.
- ☐ Keep counting when a note begins between beats.
- ☐ Feel 6/8 and 9/8 as groups of three eighths.
- ☐ Distinguish triplets from ordinary eighth notes.
- ☐ Let an offbeat note continue across a strong beat.
- ☐ Feel three large dotted-quarter beats in each 9/8 bar and place the pickup calmly.

My next practice goal

What sounded better? What still needs work?

Making the Melody Sing

Balance, phrase direction, articulation, pedal and deliberate expressive timing.

How to use these notes

Read alongside the lessons or keep beside your piano. Review the explanations, try the practice tasks, then use the checklist without on-screen hints. Listening and demonstrations are available in the app. Notation examples show the opening two bars; full songs are in the Songbook.

In this chapter

1. Bring out the melody
2. Shape a phrase toward its arrival
3. Connect and release intentionally
4. Clear pedal changes
5. Expression without losing the pulse
6. Abide with Me: a singing line
7. Just As I Am: clear pedalling
8. It Is Well with My Soul

1. Bring out the melody

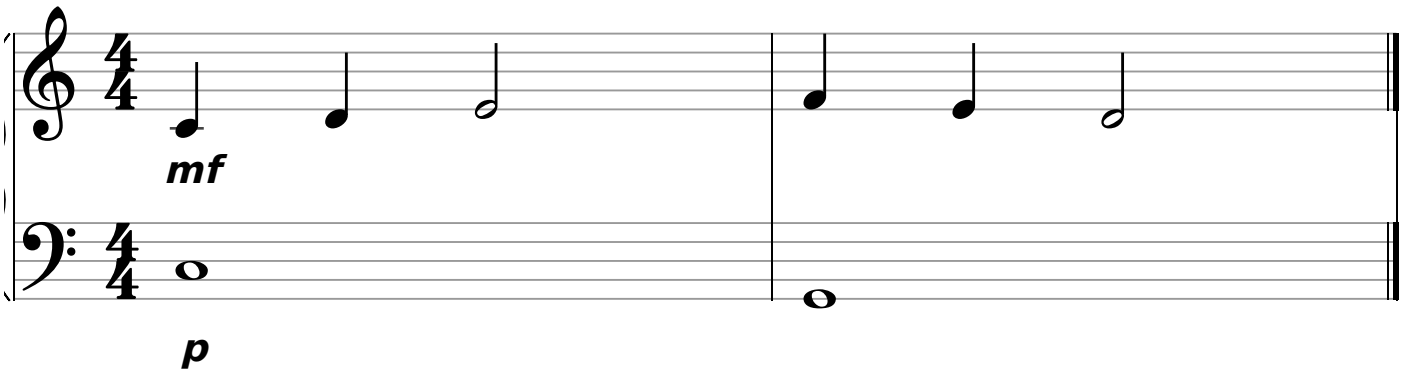
Play two different sound levels at the same time.

Bring out the melody

Imagine one singer with a quiet accompaniment. First play the melody alone and decide its sound. Add the left hand so lightly that the tune remains easy to follow. Louder melody does not mean a tense right hand: use a supported arm movement and less left-hand weight. A phone cannot reliably measure the balance between individual chord tones.

Practise · Melody over quiet bass

Sing the right-hand line while keeping the left hand soft.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Reverse the roles

Now listen to the left hand as a melody. Keep the right-hand chords very soft.

Listen and check

Listen back if you can record on your own device. Can you hum the featured line without concentrating? If not, reduce the accompanying hand.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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2. Shape a phrase toward its arrival

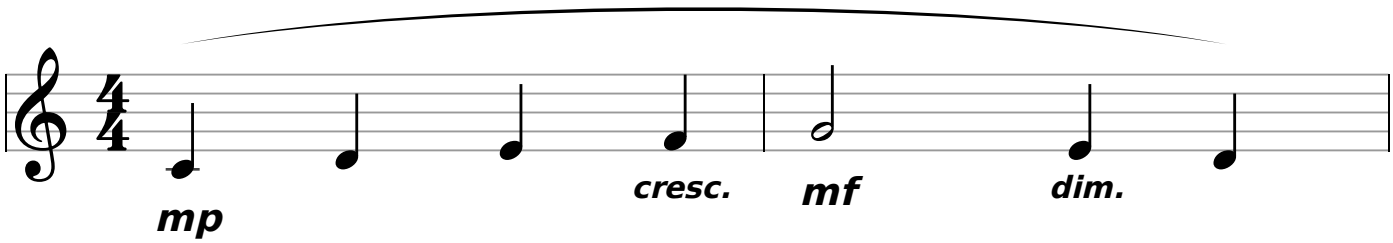
Use a clear destination instead of swelling on every note.

Shape a phrase toward its arrival

Sing the melody and notice where it wants to arrive. Choose one destination note in a phrase; grow toward it gently, then release the energy. The highest note is not automatically the loudest. A breath between phrases should not become an extra beat unless the music calls for it.

Practise · One destination

Let G be the arrival. Ease away through the second bar.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · An answering phrase

Make the second phrase a gentler answer.

Listen and check

Mark the arrival note before playing. Does the phrase sound like one sentence, or like a separate accent on every beat?

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

3. Connect and release intentionally

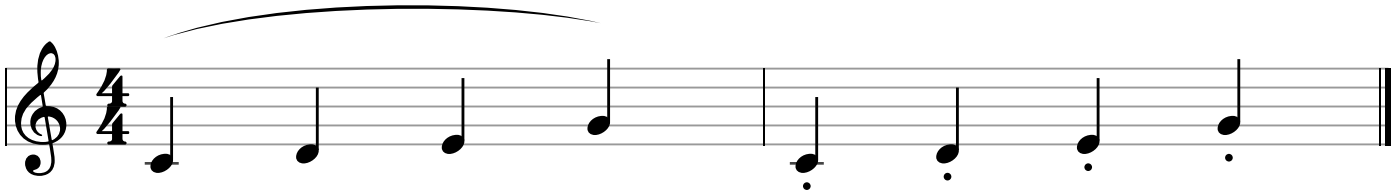
Separate legato, detached notes and phrase endings.

Connect and release intentionally

Legato means connected sound, not fingers pressed harder into the key bed. Release a finger as the next note takes over. Detached notes have a deliberate space; staccato needs a light release rather than a large bounce. Practise without pedal so your fingers create the connection.

Practise · Connected then detached

Make the first group smooth and the second light.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Phrase-end release

Let the final half note last fully, then use the written rest to breathe.

Listen and check

Can you hear the difference without looking at your hands? Check that the phrase-end rest is silence rather than lingering pedal.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

4. Clear pedal changes

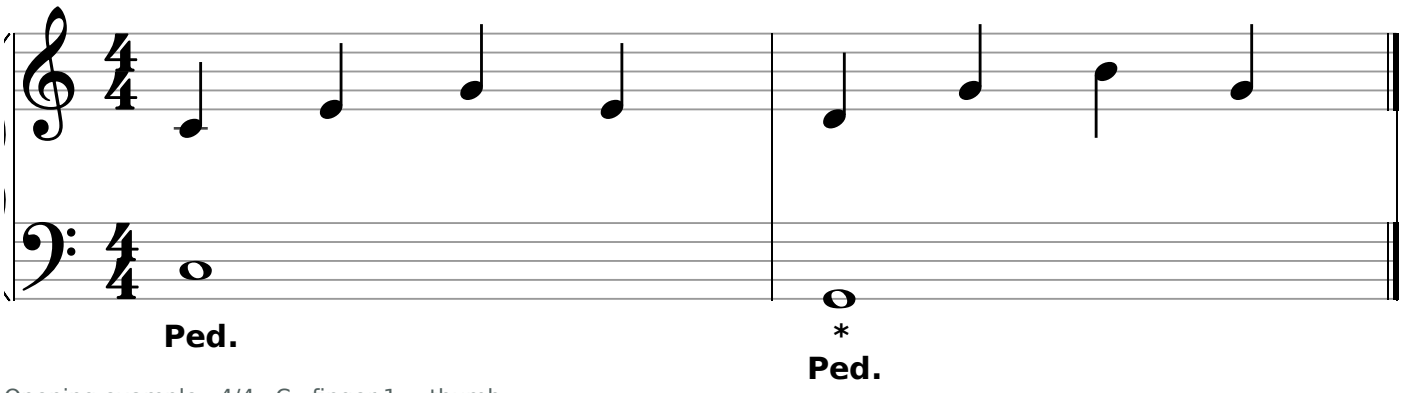
Change just after a new harmony sounds.

Clear pedal changes

First learn the notes without pedal. For a connected pedal change, play the new harmony, lift the old pedal immediately, then press again while the new keys are still held. This clears the old harmony without leaving a large gap. Keep the heel supported. Room acoustics and piano resonance decide how much pedal is useful.

Practise · Two harmonies

Coordinate the pedal change after the new bass sounds.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Clean final release

Lift at the rest, then finish without a blur.

Listen and check

Listen without watching the pedal. Do the old chord tones disappear after each change? On a very resonant piano, use less pedal or practise without it.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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5. Expression without losing the pulse

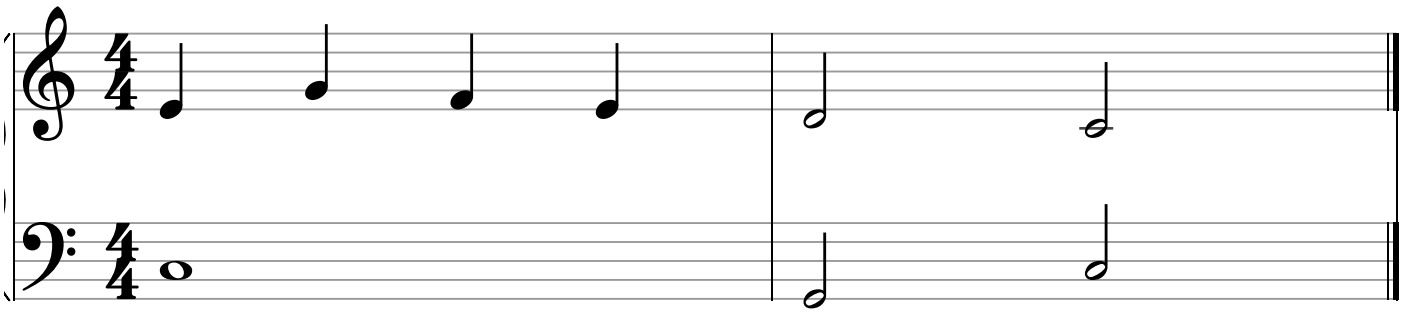
Choose where to broaden and how to recover the tempo.

Expression without losing the pulse

A phrase can breathe while its pulse remains understandable. First play in strict time. Then choose a small easing at the final cadence and return to the original tempo for the next phrase. Repeated hesitation at a hard bar is a practice problem, not expressive timing. Use the ordinary lesson for expressive runs; Flow expects steadier note starts.

Practise · First, strict time

Keep this balanced phrase exactly in time.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Plan the final arrival

Play in time first; then try a small broadening only at the final C.

Listen and check

Could you describe exactly where you changed the timing? Repeat the hard bar in strict time to check that your choice is deliberate.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

---

6. Abide with Me: a singing line

Sing each phrase first. Choose one destination and keep the left hand below the melody in volume.

What to listen for

Sing each phrase first. Choose one destination and keep the left hand below the melody in volume.

Prepare the opening with separate hands. Then use Play along, choose the hand you want to practise, and loop the troublesome bars. Count the pickup as bar 1 in the loop selector.

Practise · Melody alone

Sing each phrase first. Choose one destination and keep the left hand below the melody in volume.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Accompaniment alone

Play the left hand softly. Count through the held notes and rests.

Practise · Opening together

Sing each phrase first. Choose one destination and keep the left hand below the melody in volume.

Practise · Abide with Me: a singing line

Sing each phrase first. Choose one destination and keep the left hand below the melody in volume.

Your musical check

Can a listener hum the melody without concentrating on it?

Play again without the demonstration. Explain what you changed and whether it sounded better.

---

7. Just As I Am: clear pedalling

Learn the notes without pedal. Add small, clean changes only after the new harmony sounds. This source uses 6/4.
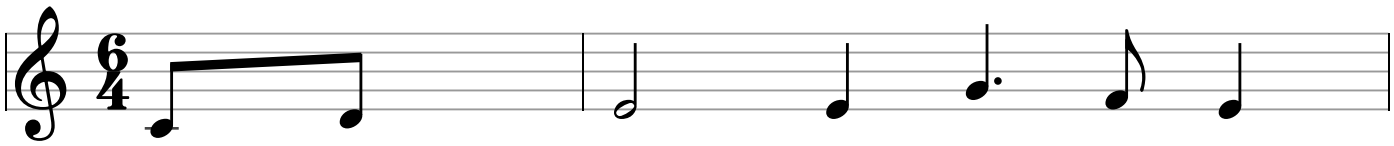
What to listen for

Learn the notes without pedal. Add small, clean changes only after the new harmony sounds. This source uses 6/4.

Prepare the opening with separate hands. Then use Play along, choose the hand you want to practise, and loop the troublesome bars. Count the pickup as bar 1 in the loop selector.

Practise · Melody alone

Learn the notes without pedal. Add small, clean changes only after the new harmony sounds. This source uses 6/4.



Opening example · 6/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Accompaniment alone

Play the left hand softly. Count through the held notes and rests.

Practise · Opening together

Learn the notes without pedal. Add small, clean changes only after the new harmony sounds. This source uses 6/4.

Practise · Just As I Am: clear pedalling

Learn the notes without pedal. Add small, clean changes only after the new harmony sounds. This source uses 6/4.

Your musical check

Listen for old harmonies blurring across the changes; reduce pedal if needed.

Play again without the demonstration. Explain what you changed and whether it sounded better.

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8. It Is Well with My Soul

Keep the melody prominent, connect phrases and clear the pedal when the harmony changes.

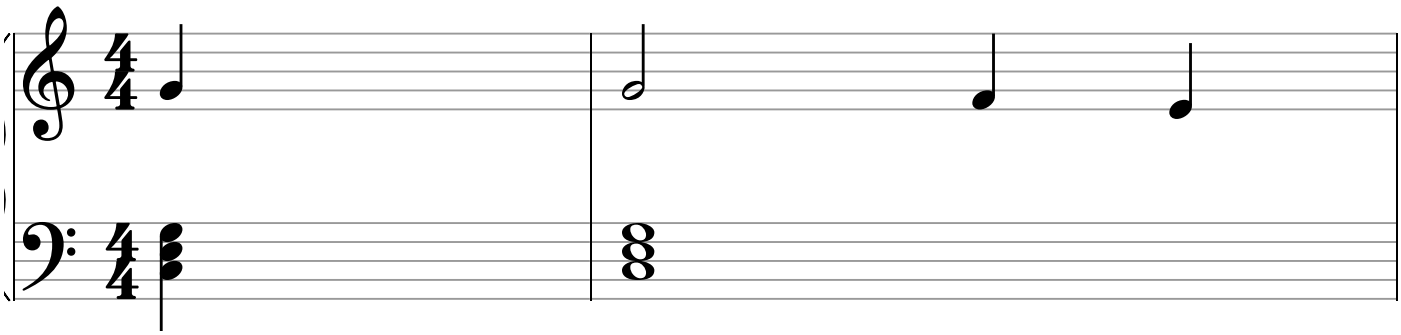
Prepare your recital

Keep the melody prominent, connect phrases and clear the pedal when the harmony changes.

Choose a comfortable tempo. Practise difficult bars separately, then reconnect them. Make one uninterrupted run before marking your recital complete. Completion records a play-through, not a certified grade.

Practise · Dress rehearsal: It Is Well with My Soul

Keep the melody prominent, connect phrases and clear the pedal when the harmony changes.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Your recital

Take a breath, prepare the starting notes, and play through. Keep going after a small mistake. Keep the melody prominent, connect phrases and clear the pedal when the harmony changes.

Can I do this independently?

Try these at your piano with hints and note labels turned off. Tick a box when you can do it comfortably; return to the matching lesson when you need a reminder.

- ☐ Play two different sound levels at the same time.
- ☐ Use a clear destination instead of swelling on every note.
- ☐ Separate legato, detached notes and phrase endings.
- ☐ Change just after a new harmony sounds.
- ☐ Choose where to broaden and how to recover the tempo.
- ☐ Keep the melody prominent, connect phrases and clear the pedal when the harmony changes.

My next practice goal

What sounded better? What still needs work?

Independent Hands and Musical Voices

Held notes, different touches, moving bass and compact hymn textures.

How to use these notes

Read alongside the lessons or keep beside your piano. Review the explanations, try the practice tasks, then use the checklist without on-screen hints. Listening and demonstrations are available in the app. Notation examples show the opening two bars; full songs are in the Songbook.

In this chapter

1. Hold one voice while another moves
2. Different touches in each hand
3. A bass line with direction
4. Melody with supporting harmony
5. Read a manageable hymn texture
6. The Doxology: supporting voices
7. All Hail the Power of Jesus' Name: opening study
8. Crown Him with Many Crowns

1. Hold one voice while another moves

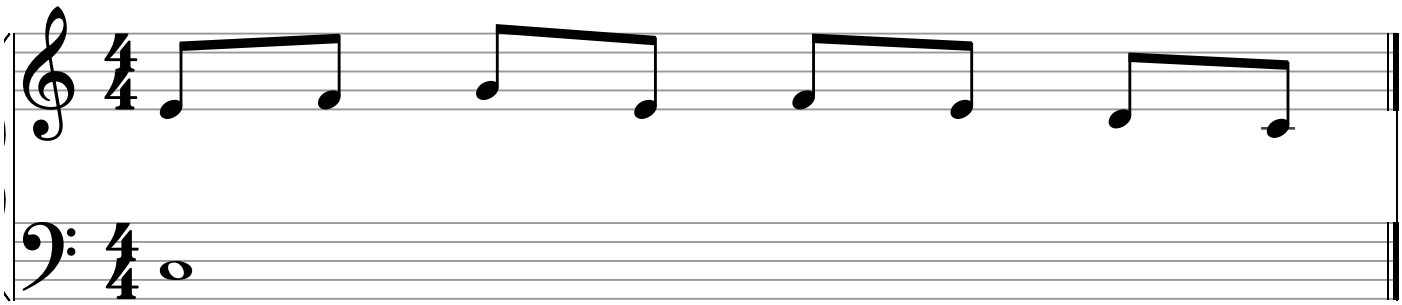
Notice which notes must continue sounding.

Hold one voice while another moves

A voice is a musical line, even when one hand plays more than one line. Begin with the hands separated: one holds while the other moves. Before releasing, check whether that particular voice has finished. Pedal can hide early releases, so first practise without it.

Practise · A held bass line

Keep the bass down until its written change.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · A held upper line

Keep the right-hand G held while the left hand walks.

Listen and check

Listen for a sudden hole in the long line. Practise releasing the moving hand without disturbing the held hand.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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2. Different touches in each hand

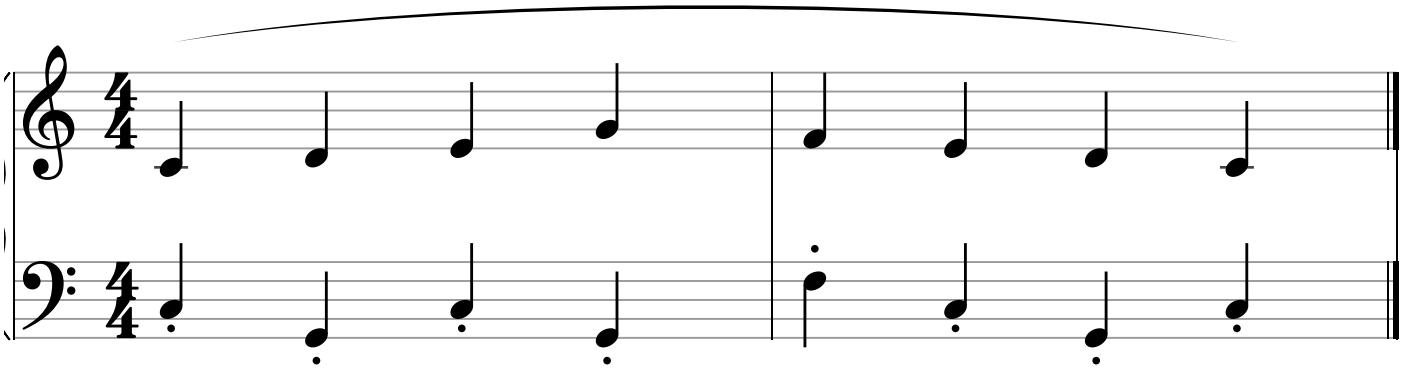
Connect one line while the other is detached.

Different touches in each hand

The two hands can have different jobs. Practise each touch alone, then combine only one bar. Aim for a connected melody over a gently detached accompaniment. Avoid a large wrist bounce in one hand that shakes the other hand out of its phrase.

Practise · Smooth melody, short bass

Keep the right hand connected and make the bass light.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Swap the task

The left-hand line sings while the upper notes release lightly.

Listen and check

Could you hear two different touches? If both hands copy the same articulation, combine just the first two beats until the jobs feel independent.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

3. A bass line with direction

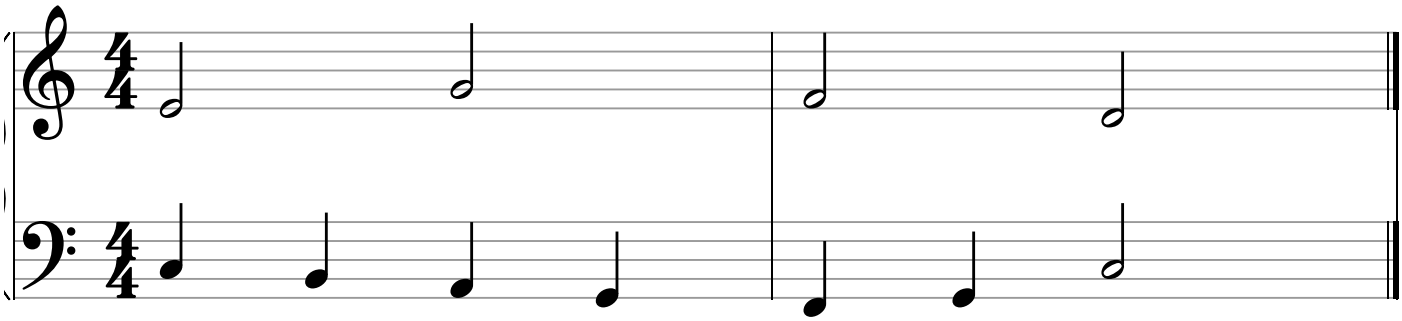
Give the lowest line its own shape.

A bass line with direction

A bass line can travel toward the next harmony instead of jumping between roots. Name its direction and listen for steps that connect the chords. Keep the bass clear but below the melody in volume. A passing bass note does not always mean a completely new chord.

Practise · A descending line

Keep the upper melody clear while the bass steps down.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Approach the cadence

Let the bass walk toward G before returning home.

Listen and check

Play and sing only the bass. Then add the melody without making the bass sound like an unrelated exercise.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

4. Melody with supporting harmony

Keep the upper note audible in a two-note right hand.

Melody with supporting harmony

A right-hand chord can contain a melody on top and a quiet supporting note beneath it. Practise only the top notes first. Add the lower notes softly while keeping the top line easy to sing. The paired notes below share a rhythm; later independent inner voices require more specialised notation and practice.

Practise · A singing top note

Hear E-F-G-E as the melody, not a sequence of equally loud blocks.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Add a quiet foundation

Keep the right-hand top line above both supporting parts.

Listen and check

If the melody disappears, remove the lower right-hand note and rebuild. Do not try to solve the balance by making every note louder.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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5. Read a manageable hymn texture

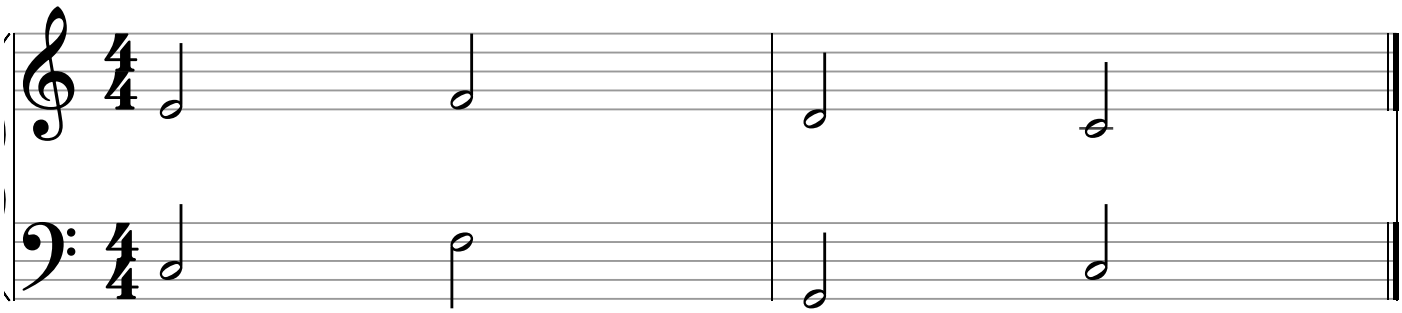
Reduce a chord before making a difficult stretch.

Read a manageable hymn texture

A printed hymn often contains four singing parts. A pianist may redistribute or omit a doubled note while keeping the melody, essential harmony and bass. Read the outer lines first, then add supporting tones. Do not force octaves or large chords; a comfortable reduction is musically useful.

Practise · Outer voices first

Hear the tune above the bass before adding inner tones.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · A compact hymn texture

Add supporting harmony without changing the outer lines.

Listen and check

Name the melody and bass in the recital score. If a chord is uncomfortable, keep the top melody and lowest bass and omit a doubled supporting tone during offline practice.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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6. The Doxology: supporting voices

Read the outer lines first, then add the left-hand chord tones softly.

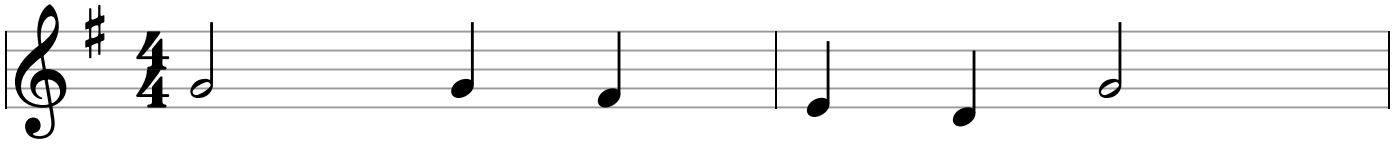
What to listen for

Read the outer lines first, then add the left-hand chord tones softly.

Prepare the opening with separate hands. Then use Play along, choose the hand you want to practise, and loop the troublesome bars. Count the pickup as bar 1 in the loop selector.

Practise · Melody alone

Read the outer lines first, then add the left-hand chord tones softly.



Opening example · 4/4 · G · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Accompaniment alone

Play the left hand softly. Count through the held notes and rests.

Practise · Opening together

Read the outer lines first, then add the left-hand chord tones softly.

Practise · The Doxology: supporting voices

Read the outer lines first, then add the left-hand chord tones softly.

Your musical check

Identify which tones belong to the melody and which support its harmony.

Play again without the demonstration. Explain what you changed and whether it sounded better.

---

7. All Hail the Power of Jesus' Name: opening study

Play the source-checked opening with a clear pickup. Let the bass travel under repeated melody

notes.
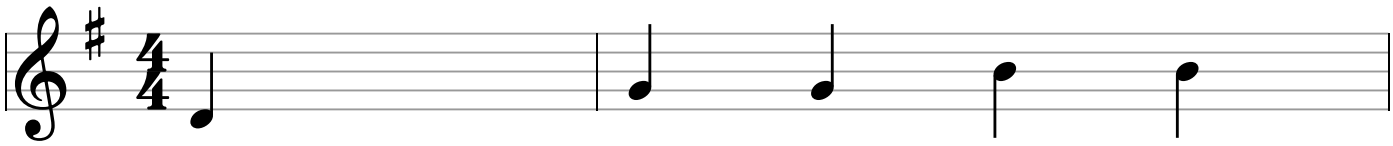
What to listen for

Play the source-checked opening with a clear pickup. Let the bass travel under repeated melody notes.

Prepare the opening with separate hands. Then use Play along, choose the hand you want to practise, and loop the troublesome bars. Count the pickup as bar 1 in the loop selector.

Practise · Melody alone

Play the source-checked opening with a clear pickup. Let the bass travel under repeated melody notes.



Opening example · 4/4 · G · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Accompaniment alone

Play the left hand softly. Count through the held notes and rests.

Practise · Opening together

Play the source-checked opening with a clear pickup. Let the bass travel under repeated melody notes.

Practise · All Hail the Power of Jesus' Name: opening study

Play the source-checked opening with a clear pickup. Let the bass travel under repeated melody notes.

Your musical check

Play the bass alone and listen to its direction, then restore the melody.

Play again without the demonstration. Explain what you changed and whether it sounded better.

---

8. Crown Him with Many Crowns

Keep the melody above the compact supporting chords. This teaching edition halves the source note values and re-bars the changing source metres in 4/4 without changing note-length

proportions.

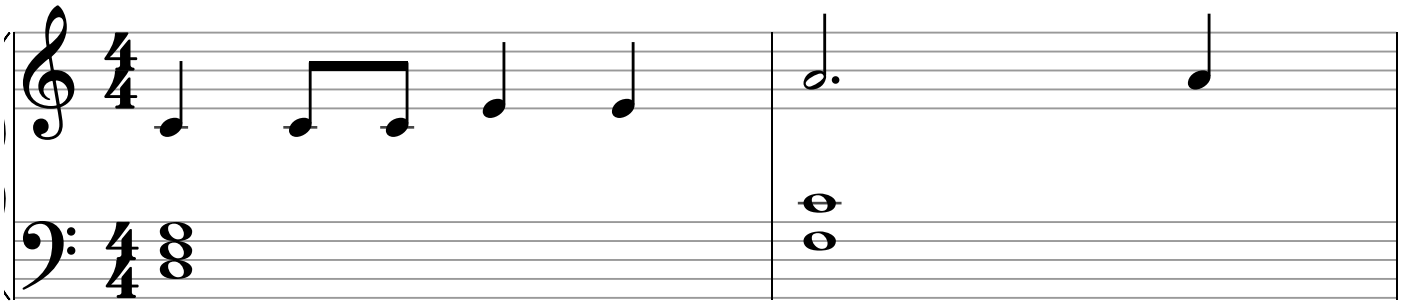
Prepare your recital

Keep the melody above the compact supporting chords. This teaching edition halves the source note values and re-bars the changing source metres in 4/4 without changing note-length proportions.

Choose a comfortable tempo. Practise difficult bars separately, then reconnect them. Make one uninterrupted run before marking your recital complete. Completion records a play-through, not a certified grade.

Practise · Dress rehearsal: Crown Him with Many Crowns

Keep the melody above the compact supporting chords. This teaching edition halves the source note values and re-bars the changing source metres in 4/4 without changing note-length proportions.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Your recital

Take a breath, prepare the starting notes, and play through. Keep going after a small mistake. Keep the melody above the compact supporting chords. This teaching edition halves the source note values and re-bars the changing source metres in 4/4 without changing note-length proportions.

Can I do this independently?

Try these at your piano with hints and note labels turned off. Tick a box when you can do it comfortably; return to the matching lesson when you need a reminder.

- [ ] Notice which notes must continue sounding.
- [ ] Connect one line while the other is detached.
- [ ] Give the lowest line its own shape.
- [ ] Keep the upper note audible in a two-note right hand.
- [ ] Reduce a chord before making a difficult stretch.
- [ ] Keep the melody above the compact supporting chords. This teaching edition halves the source note values and re-bars the changing source metres in 4/4 without changing note-length proportions.

My next practice goal

What sounded better? What still needs work?

Playing Hymns Beyond the Written Notes

Lead sheets, accompaniment styles, transposition, introductions and learning by ear.

How to use these notes

Read alongside the lessons or keep beside your piano. Review the explanations, try the practice tasks, then use the checklist without on-screen hints. Listening and demonstrations are available in the app. Notation examples show the opening two bars; full songs are in the Songbook.

In this chapter

1. Read a melody and chord symbols
2. Choose an accompaniment style
3. Move a short hymn into another key
4. Give the singer a clear beginning
5. Find, vary and arrange a melody
6. Be Thou My Vision: choose a texture
7. What a Friend: introduction and transposition
8. Come Thou Fount

1. Read a melody and chord symbols

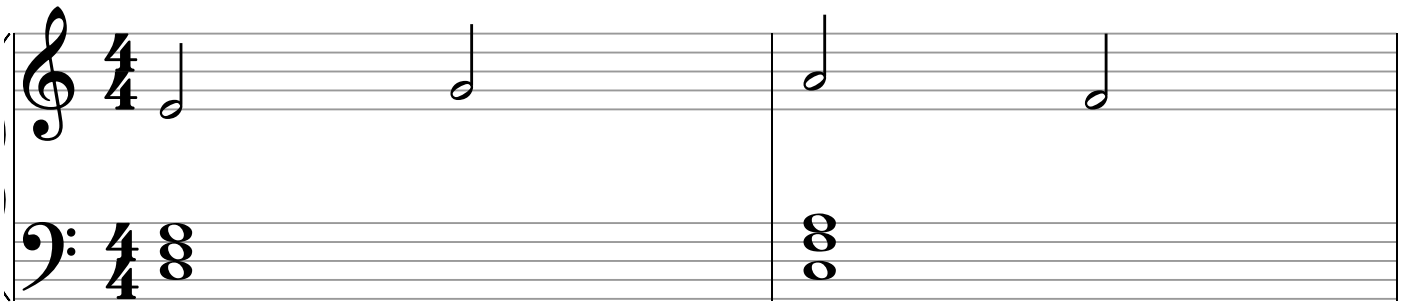
Turn a lead sheet into a simple accompaniment.

Read a melody and chord symbols

A chord symbol names harmony, not a required rhythm or inversion. C means C major, Am means A minor, and G7 means G dominant seventh. First play the melody alone, then roots alone, then choose a compact voicing. The written exercise gives one possible realisation; your offline version may use a different comfortable inversion.

Practise · Read C, F, G7, C

Say the symbol at each new harmony.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Listen and check

Cover the written left hand and play from the four chord names. Check that the harmony changes at the right moment, not on every melody note.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

---

2. Choose an accompaniment style
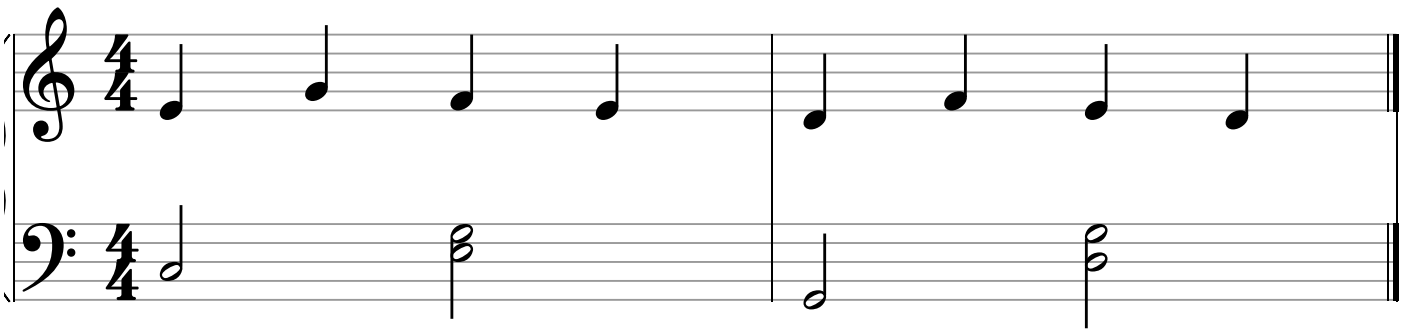
Match the pattern to the character and metre.

Choose an accompaniment style

A quiet hymn may need only a bass note and a gentle chord. A flowing hymn can use broken chords, while a strong processional may suit measured chordal playing. A busier pattern is not automatically better. Keep one chosen pattern steady long enough for the singer to feel supported.

Practise · Bass then chord

Give each bar a clear foundation and a soft response.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Flowing alternative

Keep the same harmony but divide it into moving notes.

Listen and check

Choose the calmer version for a singer who needs space. Explain why your pattern suits the hymn rather than choosing the one with more notes.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

3. Move a short hymn into another key
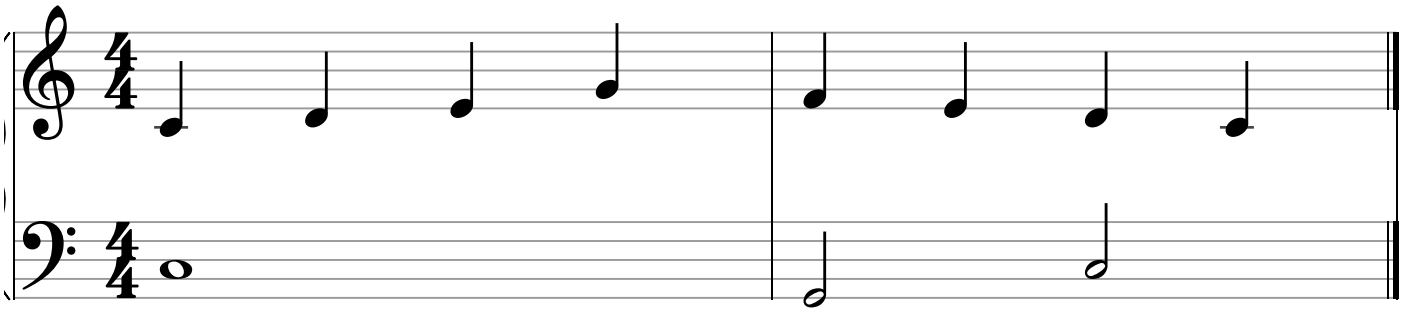
Think in scale degrees and chord functions.

Move a short hymn into another key

Transposition keeps the distances and harmonic functions while changing the home note. First sing the melody as scale degrees: 1-2-3-5. In G those notes are G-A-B-D; the I and V chords become G and D. Work one phrase at a time. Check the new key signature before playing, and choose a range comfortable for the singer.

Practise · A phrase in C

Hear 1-2-3-5, then 4-3-2-1.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · The same phrase in G

Keep the pattern and pulse; start on G.

Listen and check

Before looking, find the first four notes in F. Then transpose two bars of What a Friend using the melody and chord functions, not a fixed hand shape.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

4. Give the singer a clear beginning

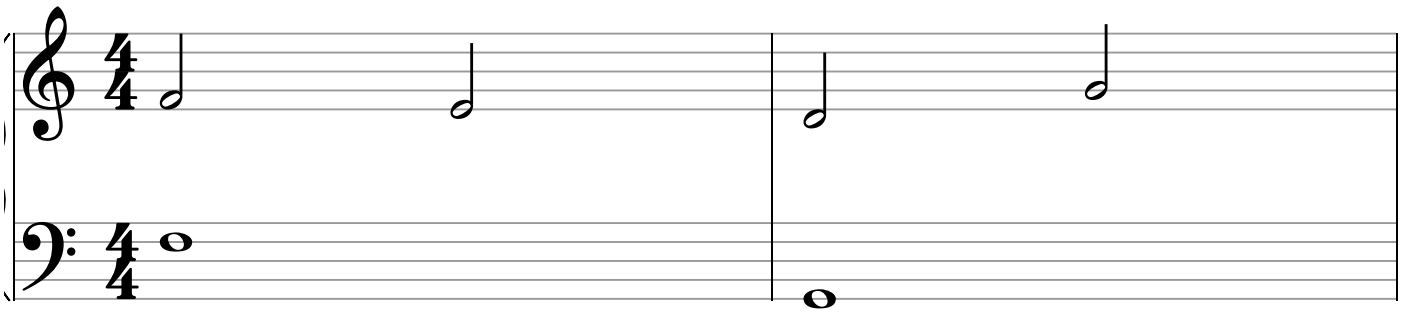
Prepare the key, tempo and entry point.

Give the singer a clear beginning

A useful introduction tells singers where the tune starts, how fast it moves and when to enter. The last phrase of the hymn can make a familiar introduction. End with a clear cadence and leave space to breathe. Do not add an elaborate flourish that hides the starting pulse.

Practise · A four-bar introduction

Keep the tempo clear and let the final cadence prepare the entry.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · A short Amen

Use this only when it suits the hymn and the setting.

Listen and check

Count an imaginary singer into the next phrase after the introduction. Would they know exactly when to begin?

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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5. Find, vary and arrange a melody

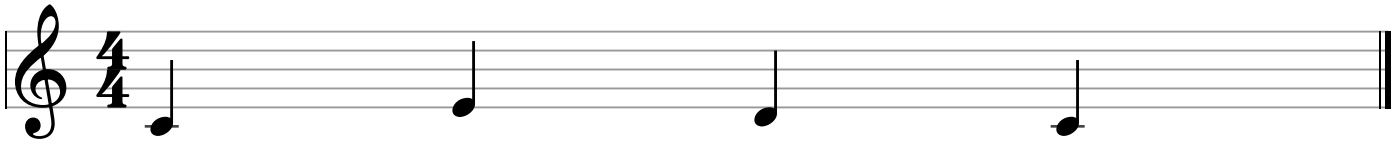
Use your ear before writing an accompaniment.

Find, vary and arrange a melody

Listen to the three-note example, sing it, then find it without looking. Begin with the direction and the home note. For a creative variation, keep the phrase length and change one rhythm or ending. Creative tasks have several valid answers: the exercise checks one reference melody, while your own version is judged by listening.

Practise · Copy this reference by ear

Listen, sing, then hide the hints before playing. This is the reference answer.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · A possible answer phrase

After this example, make your own four-beat reply offline.

> **Review · ear training**
>
> Listen. Which direction does the opening move?
>
> Listen to the example in the app before checking the answer.
>
> **Answer:** Up, then back down C rises to E, then returns through D to C.

Listen and check

Make a short arrangement plan for Come Thou Fount: choose key, pulse, pattern, introduction and ending. Play your own version offline; use the written recital as a model rather than the only correct arrangement.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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6. Be Thou My Vision: choose a texture

Use this broken-chord model, then try a simpler bass-and-chord version offline. Keep the phrase length unchanged.
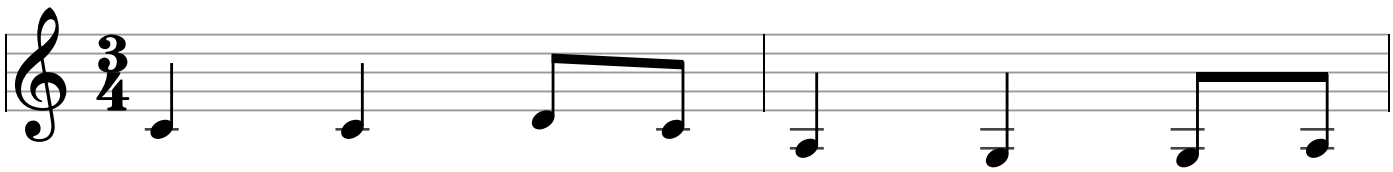
What to listen for

Use this broken-chord model, then try a simpler bass-and-chord version offline. Keep the phrase length unchanged.

Prepare the opening with separate hands. Then use Play along, choose the hand you want to practise, and loop the troublesome bars. Count the pickup as bar 1 in the loop selector.

Practise · Melody alone

Use this broken-chord model, then try a simpler bass-and-chord version offline. Keep the phrase length unchanged.



Opening example · 3/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Accompaniment alone

Play the left hand softly. Count through the held notes and rests.

Practise · Opening together

Use this broken-chord model, then try a simpler bass-and-chord version offline. Keep the phrase length unchanged.

Practise · Be Thou My Vision: choose a texture

Use this broken-chord model, then try a simpler bass-and-chord version offline. Keep the phrase length unchanged.

Your musical check

Explain which accompaniment leaves the most space for a singer.

Play again without the demonstration. Explain what you changed and whether it sounded better.

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7. What a Friend: introduction and transposition

Learn the written F-major model, then transpose one phrase offline using scale degrees and chord functions.
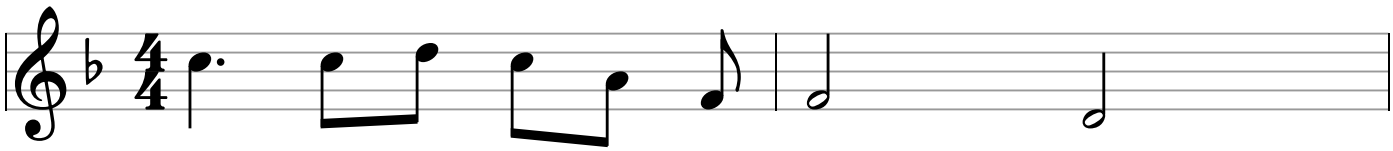
What to listen for

Learn the written F-major model, then transpose one phrase offline using scale degrees and chord functions.

Prepare the opening with separate hands. Then use Play along, choose the hand you want to practise, and loop the troublesome bars. Count the pickup as bar 1 in the loop selector.

Practise · Melody alone

Learn the written F-major model, then transpose one phrase offline using scale degrees and chord functions.



Opening example · 4/4 · F · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Accompaniment alone

Play the left hand softly. Count through the held notes and rests.

Practise · Opening together

Learn the written F-major model, then transpose one phrase offline using scale degrees and chord functions.

Practise · What a Friend: introduction and transposition

Learn the written F-major model, then transpose one phrase offline using scale degrees and chord functions.

Your musical check

Prepare an introduction from a familiar ending and count an imaginary singer in.

Play again without the demonstration. Explain what you changed and whether it sounded better.

8. Come Thou Fount

Use the written arrangement as a model. Before the recital, create and play your own short introduction offline; the app checks the reference score only.

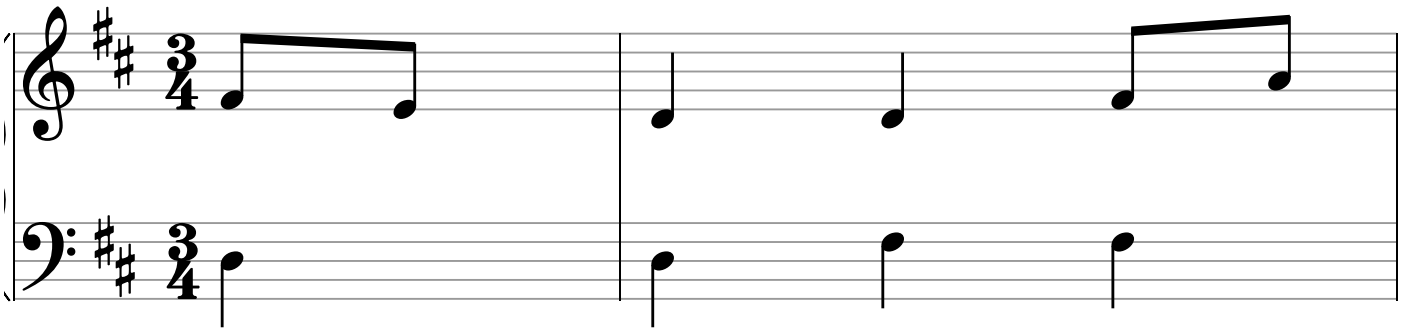
Prepare your recital

Use the written arrangement as a model. Before the recital, create and play your own short introduction offline; the app checks the reference score only.

Choose a comfortable tempo. Practise difficult bars separately, then reconnect them. Make one uninterrupted run before marking your recital complete. Completion records a play-through, not a certified grade.

Practise · Dress rehearsal: Come Thou Fount

Use the written arrangement as a model. Before the recital, create and play your own short introduction offline; the app checks the reference score only.



Opening example · 3/4 · D · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Your recital

Take a breath, prepare the starting notes, and play through. Keep going after a small mistake. Use the written arrangement as a model. Before the recital, create and play your own short introduction offline; the app checks the reference score only.

Can I do this independently?

Try these at your piano with hints and note labels turned off. Tick a box when you can do it comfortably; return to the matching lesson when you need a reminder.

- [ ] Turn a lead sheet into a simple accompaniment.
- [ ] Match the pattern to the character and metre.
- [ ] Think in scale degrees and chord functions.
- [ ] Prepare the key, tempo and entry point.
- [ ] Use your ear before writing an accompaniment.
- [ ] Use the written arrangement as a model. Before the recital, create and play your own short introduction offline; the app checks the reference score only.

My next practice goal

What sounded better? What still needs work?

Preparing a Complete Performance

Interpretation, diagnosis, restart points, recovery and a sustained two-piece programme.

How to use these notes

Read alongside the lessons or keep beside your piano. Review the explanations, try the practice tasks, then use the checklist without on-screen hints. Listening and demonstrations are available in the app. Notation examples show the opening two bars; full songs are in the Songbook.

In this chapter

1. Make a performance plan
2. Find the cause of a difficult passage
3. Start from several places
4. Recover gracefully in performance
5. Sustain the whole performance
6. Dress rehearsal: It Is Well
7. Dress rehearsal: Come Thou Fount
8. A lyrical hymn and a confident hymn

1. Make a performance plan

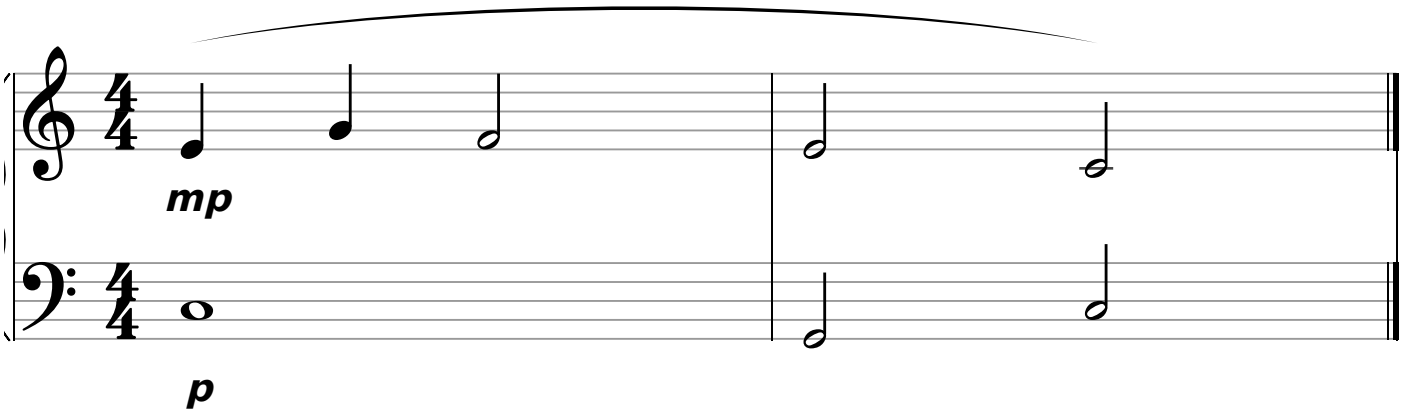
Choose tempo, phrase shapes and the character of each piece.

Make a performance plan

Before a final performance, choose two contrasting hymns: one lyrical and one with a confident pulse. Write down the key, comfortable tempo, phrase destinations and pedal plan. Choose a sound you can sustain through the whole piece. A slower coherent performance communicates more than a rushed one with frequent stops.

Practise · Choose a lyrical sound

Use this phrase to settle your balance and tone.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Listen and check

Describe the character in one sentence. Can another listener hear that intention, or is it only written in your plan?

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

---

2. Find the cause of a difficult passage

Separate reading, movement and rhythm problems.

Find the cause of a difficult passage

A difficult bar needs a diagnosis. If you cannot name the notes, read first. If the notes are known but the move fails, practise the landing silently. If hands alone work but together fail, tap the coordination. Loop two bars including the approach, not only the note that went wrong. Stop repeating when tension increases.

Practise · Prepare the landing

Use the rest to move the hand before the high note.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Coordination check

Tap this rhythm away from the keys before playing.

Listen and check

Write one specific cause and one specific solution. Replace play it again with an instruction such as prepare the thumb before beat three.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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3. Start from several places
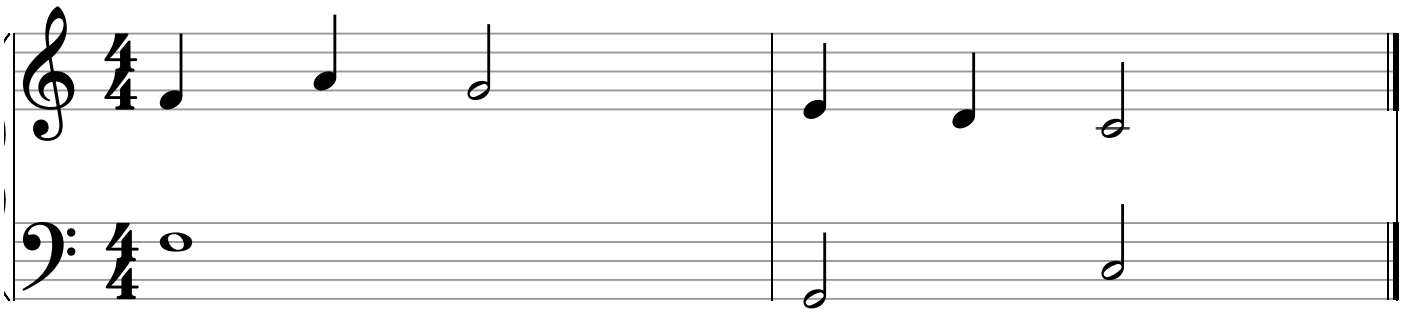
Build secure musical landmarks rather than one long chain.

Start from several places

Choose the beginning of each phrase and practise starting there without running in from the beginning. Name the first melody note, bass note and chord. Then join the last bar of one phrase to the next. This builds recovery points and checks whether you know the structure rather than only the finger sequence.

Practise · Start at phrase two

Prepare both starting notes before the count-in.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Join across the boundary

Make the arrival and new beginning part of one pulse.

Listen and check

Start your recital from three named phrase beginnings. The notation may stay available; secure reading and secure memory can support one another.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

---

4. Recover gracefully in performance
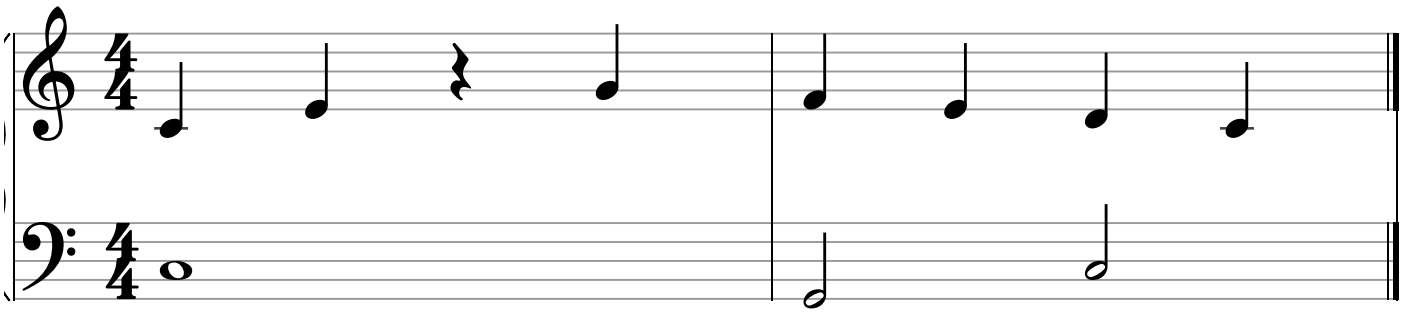
Keep time and rejoin at the next safe landmark.

Recover gracefully in performance

Practise recovery deliberately on an easy passage. During an offline run, leave out a melody note but keep counting and continue at the next beat. Do not practise errors repeatedly in the difficult passage itself. After the run, return to careful repair. A mistake is useful information rather than a reason to abandon the whole performance.

Practise · A planned gap

Count the written rest as a safe simulation of a missed note.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Listen and check

Could you keep the pulse through the gap? Choose a tempo at which you can continue calmly. Use Wait for repair and Flow for an uninterrupted timing rehearsal.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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5. Sustain the whole performance
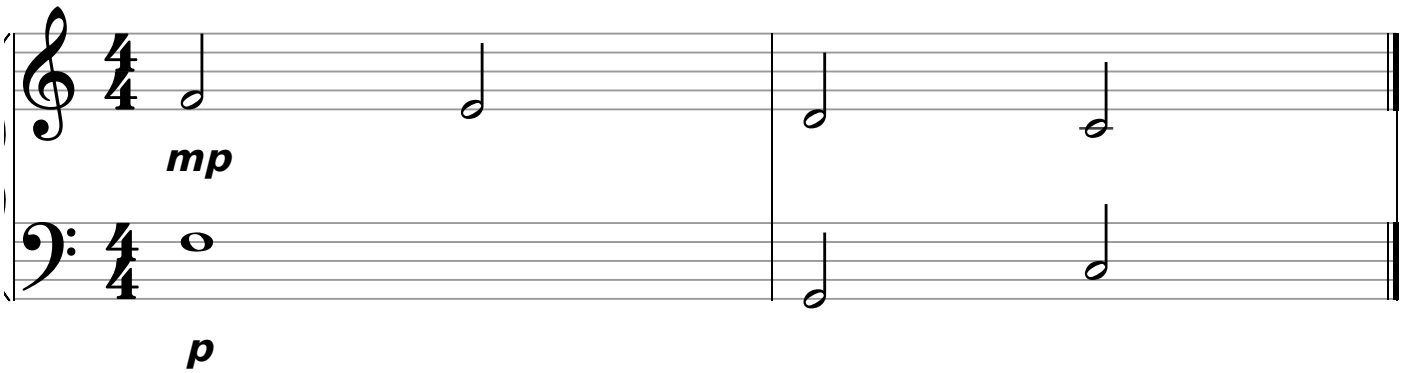
Prepare a final recital and reflect on what you hear.

Sustain the whole performance

Make the final rehearsal feel like a performance: settle the bench, take a breath, prepare the first notes and count in. Play both selected hymns with a short quiet pause between them. Afterwards, name one successful musical choice and one next goal. Judge the whole musical story as well as individual notes.

Practise · A settled final cadence

Finish the note fully and release both hands together.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Listen and check

Are both pieces comfortable at your chosen tempos? Can you keep the melody clear, recover from a small slip and finish without rushing? Return to the relevant chapter when one skill still needs support.

The app checks pitches. Use Flow for note-start timing; judge held notes, physical ease, balance and pedal by listening. Repeat a short passage before increasing speed.

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6. Dress rehearsal: It Is Well

Rehearse without stopping. Decide the phrase destinations and pedal changes before the first note.
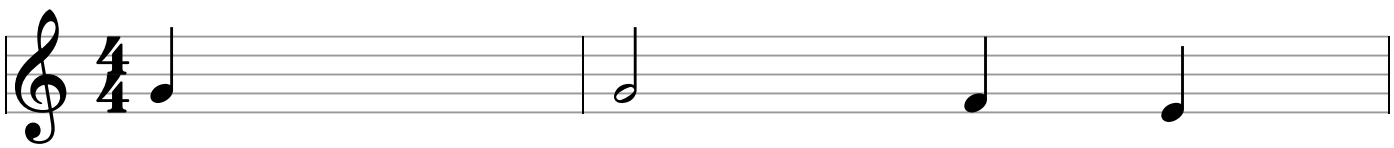
What to listen for

Rehearse without stopping. Decide the phrase destinations and pedal changes before the first note.

Prepare the opening with separate hands. Then use Play along, choose the hand you want to practise, and loop the troublesome bars. Count the pickup as bar 1 in the loop selector.

Practise · Melody alone

Rehearse without stopping. Decide the phrase destinations and pedal changes before the first note.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Accompaniment alone

Play the left hand softly. Count through the held notes and rests.

Practise · Opening together

Rehearse without stopping. Decide the phrase destinations and pedal changes before the first note.

Practise · Dress rehearsal: It Is Well

Rehearse without stopping. Decide the phrase destinations and pedal changes before the first note.

Your musical check

Afterwards name one successful musical choice and one passage needing repair.

Play again without the demonstration. Explain what you changed and whether it sounded better.

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7. Dress rehearsal: Come Thou Fount

Maintain a confident pulse through the whole hymn. Use planned phrase landmarks to recover calmly.
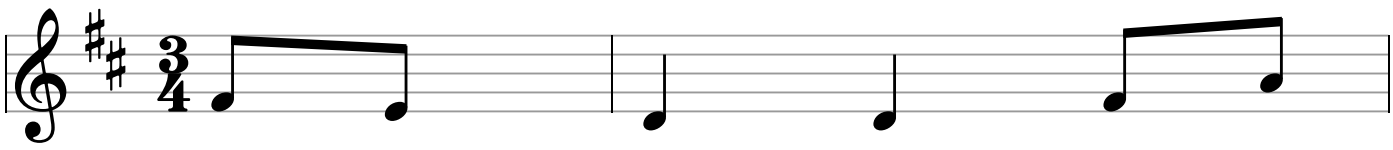
What to listen for

Maintain a confident pulse through the whole hymn. Use planned phrase landmarks to recover calmly.

Prepare the opening with separate hands. Then use Play along, choose the hand you want to practise, and loop the troublesome bars. Count the pickup as bar 1 in the loop selector.

Practise · Melody alone

Maintain a confident pulse through the whole hymn. Use planned phrase landmarks to recover calmly.



Opening example · 3/4 · D · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Accompaniment alone

Play the left hand softly. Count through the held notes and rests.

Practise · Opening together

Maintain a confident pulse through the whole hymn. Use planned phrase landmarks to recover calmly.

Practise · Dress rehearsal: Come Thou Fount

Maintain a confident pulse through the whole hymn. Use planned phrase landmarks to recover calmly.

Your musical check

Can you restart from three phrase beginnings without running in from the start?

Play again without the demonstration. Explain what you changed and whether it sounded better.

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8. A lyrical hymn and a confident hymn

Perform both complete hymns, with a short quiet pause between them. Keep the pulse, a clear melody, relaxed movement and a deliberate ending.

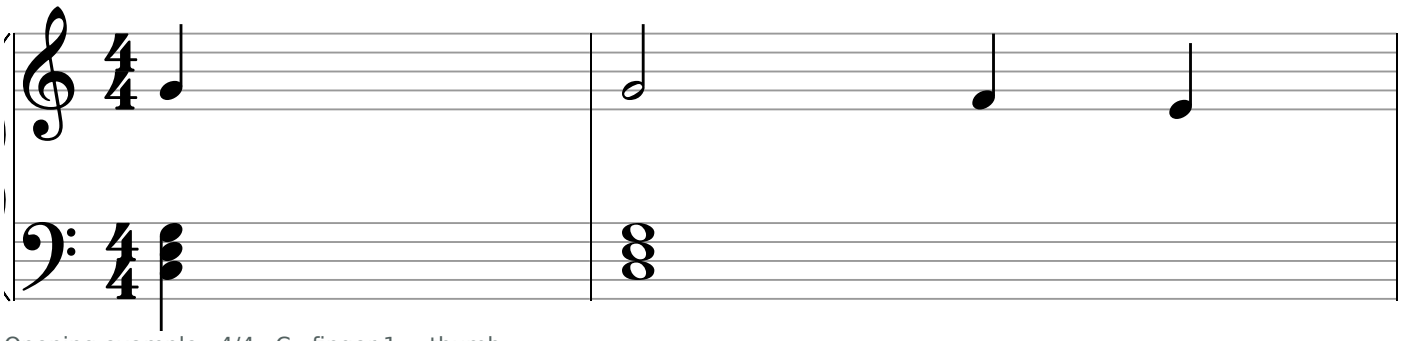
Prepare your recital

Perform both complete hymns, with a short quiet pause between them. Keep the pulse, a clear melody, relaxed movement and a deliberate ending.

Choose a comfortable tempo. Practise difficult bars separately, then reconnect them. Make one uninterrupted run before marking your recital complete. Completion records a play-through, not a certified grade.

Practise · Dress rehearsal: It Is Well with My Soul - final recital

Perform both complete hymns, with a short quiet pause between them. Keep the pulse, a clear melody, relaxed movement and a deliberate ending.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Dress rehearsal: Come Thou Fount - final recital

Perform both complete hymns, with a short quiet pause between them. Keep the pulse, a clear melody, relaxed movement and a deliberate ending.

Practise · Performance 1: It Is Well with My Soul - final recital

Take a breath, prepare the starting notes, and play through. Keep going after a small mistake. Perform both complete hymns, with a short quiet pause between them. Keep the pulse, a clear melody, relaxed movement and a deliberate ending.

Practise · Performance 2: Come Thou Fount - final recital

Take a breath, prepare the starting notes, and play through. Keep going after a small mistake. Perform both complete hymns, with a short quiet pause between them. Keep the pulse, a clear melody, relaxed movement and a deliberate ending.

Can I do this independently?

Try these at your piano with hints and note labels turned off. Tick a box when you can do it comfortably; return to the matching lesson when you need a reminder.

- ☐ Choose tempo, phrase shapes and the character of each piece.
- ☐ Separate reading, movement and rhythm problems.
- ☐ Build secure musical landmarks rather than one long chain.
- ☐ Keep time and rejoin at the next safe landmark.
- ☐ Prepare a final recital and reflect on what you hear.
- ☐ Perform both complete hymns, with a short quiet pause between them. Keep the pulse, a clear melody, relaxed movement and a deliberate ending.

My next practice goal

What sounded better? What still needs work?
